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PISTIS

Demystifying Jungian Psychology



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To my wife who sparked many insightful conversations that
contributed to giving life to this book.

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Introduction

In all honesty, I never thought I'd be writing anything in my life, let alone an introduction to Jungian Psychology. However, this is the kind of thing that can happen when you question the assumptions you have about life and yourself, new paths emerge. The writings of Carl Jung are, without a doubt, the thing that had the most impact on my life, as they were able to translate so many of my experiences that I couldn't even begin to describe. When I first started reading, I'd spend four to six hours every day trying to unravel the mysteries of the *psyche*, this period lasted for a whole year.

Since then, I started to share my thoughts and my experience as a therapist on a subreddit called r/Jung, today I'm part of the moderation team. During this period, I learned a lot from every response I received to my articles. I was able to catalog the most common doubts, difficulties, and obviously, the most relevant topics. What prompted me to write this book was witnessing many discussions without any real foundation and people struggling because they wanted to know more but didn't have the right guidance. I was once in this position and that's why I feel a sense of duty to fill this gap.

This book is for those insatiable souls, for those who have fire in their eyes and are willing to do what it takes to realize their authentic paths. This work is the result of me facing my fears and following my *pistis*. That said, I want to be very clear that this book wasn't made to reach academics, but the layman who's passionate about psychology and a Jung enthusiast. You'll see that I allow myself to be more poetic at times and use the terms a bit more loosely. My intention is to present you something real, perhaps, it can help you as much as it helped me. That's why I want to begin exploring what *pistis* means to me.

The Audacity To Carve Your Own Path

“This is not to preach “individualism,” but only the necessary pre-condition for responsible action: namely that a man should know himself and his own peculiarities and have the courage to stand by them. Only when a man lives in his own way is he responsible and capable of action—otherwise he is just a hanger-on or follower-on with no proper personality” (C. G. Jung – V16 – §42).

I must confess that these words went directly to my soul and translated something that I’ve felt in some capacity my whole life, but have only been truly conscious of for the past two or three years. As humans we crave certain answers, we don’t want to make mistakes, and have the tendency to look for systems, formulas, recipes, codes, shortcuts, and a step-by-step guide to life. That’s exactly what a religion, a political movement, or a philosophical system can give us.

Furthermore, if you pair that with a sense of belonging you have the perfect recipe for perpetuating immature adults. Where fanaticism serves as a compensation for inner doubts, and by “converting” more people to your movement, these same gnawing doubts cease for a while. The responsibility for one’s life is projected onto a “guru”, and the “community” also has a key role in this dynamic, by having an unspoken and unconscious pact to curb these very inner conflicts.

“The fact that the conventions always flourish in one form or another only proves that the vast majority of mankind do not choose their own way, but convention, and consequently develop not themselves but a method and a collective mode of life at the cost of their own wholeness” (C. G. Jung – V17 – §296).

By engaging with something ready-made and making this your own truth instead of finding your own answers, you’re disowning the most important part of your *soul* and running away from psychological maturity. The way of individuation is finding your own particular answers to life. It means carving your own path and slaying your own dragon, instead of taking pride in others’ deeds. But don’t get me wrong here, I’m not anti-religion or philosophy, this would be just dumb. We can certainly find inspiration from ancient traditions and this can serve to spark something inside of us, but that’s it. The actual process of building our own *cosmovision* (*weltanschauung*) has to be done individually and is very lengthy and laborious. It’s something Jung calls *moral confrontation*.

A highly important point here is to always remember that we live in a paradox between accommodating internal and external demands. In other words, we have to find a way of expressing our individuality in the external world, without simply disregarding or forfeiting it. On the contrary, this would be just an angry teenager rebellion or empty individuality as Jung points out. It's a fine balance between the adaptation of the *persona* and the demands of the *individuation process*.

However, listening to your inner voice and achieving freedom has a price. You have to cultivate the courage to stand by what you believe in and have the audacity of going your own way. Accepting full responsibility is imperative. As you truly engage in finding your answers, for example, entertaining the problem of good and evil, you start noticing something emerging from the depths of your *soul*. At first, it's something amorphous in its embryonic stages, however, the more you allow yourself to question your foundations and sustain the paradoxes, the more solid your convictions become.

They emerge as a new synthesis, binding the extremes into new connections at a higher level. Until you tap into a truth that can sustain you through the most difficult periods of your life. Your own internal law, your *pistis*. A solid inner foundation that propels you to become independent. It's something that inspires you, makes you feel at peace, and at the same time fuels you with creative power. You're no longer the effect, now you're the protagonist co-creating your destiny.

"I was driven to ask myself in all seriousness: "What is the myth you are living?" I found no answer to this question, and had to admit that I was not living with a myth, or even in a myth, but rather in an uncertain cloud of theoretical possibilities which I was beginning to regard with increasing distrust. I did not know that I was living a myth, and even if I had known it, I would not have known what sort of myth was ordering my life without my knowledge. So, in the most natural way, I took it upon myself to get to know "my" myth, and I regarded this as the task of tasks" (C. G. Jung – V5, p. 300).

Do you dare?

1 - The Foundations of Jungian Psychology

I imagine you'll feel tempted to skip this part, and honestly, I debated with myself if was going to bring this discussion in an introductory book to the layman. However, I see Jungian Psychology being ridiculed and treated as something outdated every day, as for Carl Jung, many people still think he was a "crazy stoner wizard trapped in a tower". It's very regrettable what people in new age groups did to his reputation. In all fairness, most "Jungians" contribute to this circus as few of them actually spend time reading Jung in the source.

That's why I feel it's my duty to not only defend Jungian Psychology but to give you the keys to unlock a new level of psychological understanding. In just a few pages, I'll attempt to summarize what took me a few years and countless restless nights to understand. After this first chapter, you'll never see Jungian Psychology the same way, everything will become clearer. Lastly, I'd like to express my gratitude to my teacher, Heráclito Pinheiro, who was a great guide to this Herculean task. This first chapter wouldn't be possible without one of his books called "O Pensamento Vivo de Jung", which loosely translates as "Jung's Living Thought". It sounds better in Portuguese, anyway, buckle up!

1.1 - Epistemology

Facts first and theories later!

"Although I have often been called a philosopher, I am an empiricist and adhere as such to the phenomenological standpoint. [...] As this statement indicates, I approach psychological matters from a scientific and not from a philosophical standpoint. Inasmuch as religion has a very important psychological aspect, I deal with it from a purely empirical point of view, that is, I restrict myself to the observation of phenomena and I eschew any metaphysical or philosophical considerations" (C.G. Jung - V11 - §2).

The first thing we have to understand about Carl Jung's methodology is that he had an empirical approach and was completely averse to metaphysical claims. Furthermore, he used the comparative and descriptive method, in other words, he was interested in describing the phenomenon instead of formulating theories. In that sense, a theory would be a closed and fixed

system, where you reduce the phenomena to a definite cause and strive to create a formula or a recipe that can be generally applied.

When Jung started developing his own ideas and epistemology, he was mainly moving away from psychoanalysis and Freud's sexual theory. Jung regarded Freud's ideas as one possible explanation among many and what drove them apart was Freud's desire to raise his sexual theory to a religious level. When you operate with a fixed system, everything will be filtered through these lenses, consequently, this will always give you the same answers and promote a reductionistic attitude that strives to fit everything in a tiny box.

A grotesque example would be a few somatic approaches that claim that if you have pain in the right side of your body, you have problems with your father and the masculine, but if the pain is in the left side of your body, you have problems with your mother and the feminine. I know it sounds sketchy, but this is what happens when you try to create a formula, it's something that appears to explain what's going on, but in reality, it doesn't. Furthermore, a generally valid formula will always disregard individuality, that's why Jung was interested in describing the nature of psychological processes, rather than formulating a fixed theory.

With his epistemology, Carl Jung also criticized positivism and the statistical method, without completely abandoning it, as he was always striving to conciliate the paradox between the collective and the individual truth. In order to do so, Jung proposed the use of the dialectical method in the therapeutic setting. In his eyes, this is the only method that can fully respect individuality, as the dialectic doesn't work with preconceived notions and fixed rules, and seeks to unravel the internal logic within the phenomena, also considering the peculiarities of the individual context. Finally, the dialectic is a method that strives to unite opposing tendencies in the *psyche* and produce a new synthesis, which Jung calls the *symbol formation process*, the core of Jungian Psychology. But don't worry about this now, there's a whole chapter dedicated to it.

Resuming our exploration, Carl Jung disregards the notion of a passive and "pure observation" of the phenomena postulated by classic empiricism. Being influenced by Kant, Jung believes that the subject is active in the process of knowing and that our pre-dispositions influence our interpretation of reality. Furthermore, Jung differs from the monist and physicalist approach that considers the *psyche* a mere fruit of brain activity. Being a dualist, he considers an interdependence

between *psyche* and body, giving each one their own dignity. In that sense, Jung's empiricism was founded on a *psychophysical equation* and a *personal equation*.

Classic empiricism postulates that humans are a *tabula rasa* to be marked by experience and that all knowledge is mediated by the five senses. However, in *Psychological Types* Jung explains that consciousness has four functions, namely *thinking*, *feeling*, *sensation*, and *intuition*. The *sensation function* is the one linked with sensory experience, however, perception isn't limited by it, we still have *intuition*, which is a form of perception via the unconscious. Thus, *intuition* perceives all the elements that come from the unconscious which consciousness perceives as *psychic images*. Therefore, Jung considers perception the sum of *sensation* and *intuition*, which constitutes the *psychophysical equation*. It's important to realize that these images aren't invented by the conscious mind, rather they spontaneously appear independent of conscious will, which leads Jung to consider the existence of an objective psyche, i.e., which can't be reduced to mere subjectivity, namely the impersonal or collective unconscious.

The second layer of Carl Jung's empiricism is the *personal equation*, as he considers the subject active in the process of knowing and severely doubts the possibility of "pure observation". Jung indicates that our subjectivity already interferes in the very process of observation, as he puts it, *one sees what one can best see oneself*. This becomes even more clear when the subject begins translating their experiences and tries to express them in words. This process will become clearer when we cover the concept of *conscious attitude* and the *psychological types*, which will be done in the second and fourth chapters respectively.

1.2 - Learned Nominalism

In the second part of our exploration, we have to cover something that's absolutely a game changer. In *Psychological Types*, Carl Jung referred to himself as a *learned nominalist*, which is neither a realist nor nominalist attitude, but rather something in between. Under this light, Jung's work consisted in cataloging his findings in certain groups, once he realized there were patterns, he'd put a name on it, like the *shadow* or the *animus* and *anima*, however, it's imperative to realize that the name itself doesn't explain "what" the thing is, as this would be a metaphysical statement, these labels are simply a map to help us better navigate the nature of the phenomenon. That's why

you'll never see Jung stating "*what*" the *shadow* is, rather, he'll describe its appearance and how it generally behaves.

In Jung's words, "In view of the enormous complexity of psychic phenomena, a purely phenomenological point of view is, and will be for a long time, the only possible one and the only one with any prospect of success. "Whence" things come and "what" they are, these, particularly in the field of psychology, are questions which are apt to call forth untimely attempts at explanation. Such speculations are moreover based far more on unconscious philosophical premises than on the nature of the phenomena themselves. Psychic phenomena occasioned by unconscious processes are so rich and so multifarious that I prefer to *describe* my findings and observations and, where possible, to classify them—that is, to arrange them under certain definite types. That is the method of natural science, and it is applied wherever we have to do with multifarious and still unorganized material. One may question the utility or the appropriateness of the categories or types used in the arrangement, but not the correctness of the method itself" (C.G. Jung - V9 - §308).

Apart from embracing many of Kant's views, Jung was also heavily influenced by William James and his pragmatic approach to psychology, from which he adopted the notion of *cash-value* and *conceptual short-cuts*. The first one refers to how our beliefs shape our immediate experience in the world. For instance, if I believe I can fly, one of the immediate impacts in my life is that I might actually try to do it by jumping off a cliff. It's interesting to realize that these beliefs may or may not be rooted in objective reality, raising the importance of our individual interpretations of reality and how this impacts the quality of our experience.

This pragmatic notion also impacted directly Jung's views on psychology, as he doesn't consider truth something static and universally valid, instead, he relates to truth in a dynamic and processual way. Truth appears in the process of validating an idea. In *Two Essays On Analytical Psychology*, Jung analyzes one particular case through two opposing points of view, Freud's sexual theory and Adler's will to power. It's incredibly interesting to see how different the conclusions are when you adopt each one of these lenses, as the treatment will be the exact opposite. As you might have guessed, Carl Jung concludes by saying that both points of view are partially valid and what will determine its applicability is the individual context. May I add, from my personal experience as a therapist, it's important to work with opposing truths at all times, as there's a variability not only in the individuals but also in their own experiences, which requires different lenses for different

situations, and more often than not, a combination of opposing perspectives. In that sense, truth is an instrument and not an end in itself. Once again, we can see why different from Freud and Adler, Jung didn't have a theory.

The second notion, *conceptual short-cuts*, has to do with how we can use Carl Jung's concepts, which he also referred to as *empirical concepts* or *experimental concepts*. Rather than saying "*what the thing is*", he wants to give us a map to navigate the *psyche*. In other words, when you can name a certain pattern, like a *complex*, it gives you an orientation on how to treat it, how the phenomenon behaves, what to expect, and what is the best direction to take. That's why just knowing a fancy name means nothing, it's just substituting the reality of the phenomena with words. For instance, I see this lazy interpretation all the time, when someone dreams with a woman, people immediately say "Oh wow, you just dreamed with your *anima*". Knowing the name of something gives you the illusion that you understood it, but in reality, this means nothing and it's not an interpretation. Even though it might be an *anima* figure, you have no idea what it means for the dreamer, why it appeared, or how to proceed. Knowing the concepts is just the first step, as they only point in the right direction so your exploration can begin. These concepts are simply an orientation and are meant to give you more work.

1.3 - Psychic Reality

Now, we're ready to explore Carl Jung's most misunderstood idea, the notion of *psychic reality* and further our understanding of his attitude toward metaphysics. In Jung's words, "It is really my purpose to push aside, without mercy, the metaphysical claims of all esoteric teaching [...] To understand metaphysically is impossible; it can only be done psychologically I therefore strip things of their metaphysical wrappings in order to make them objects of psychology" (C. G. Jung - The Secret of The Golden Flower – p. 129).

In *Structure and Dynamics of the Psyche*, Carl Jung explains that our experience happens in between two realms, the objective and concrete reality mediated by the senses and the subjective and spiritual reality of the *soul*. However, Jung proposes that regardless of these two opposing realms, every experience we have is mediated by *psychic images*. To Jung, "The only form of existence of which we have immediate knowledge is psychic. We might well say, on the contrary,

that physical existence is a mere inference, since we know of matter only in so far as we perceive psychic images mediated by the senses” (C. G. Jung - V11 – §16).

Furthermore, Jung appeals to Kant saying that we can’t ever know “*what a thing is*”. Even if we’re discussing objective experiences mediated by the senses, like witnessing a fire, the most we can do is explain its chemical reactions. But that’s it, no one can know “*what*” fire is in itself, or its “ultimate essence”, as this would also be a metaphysical statement. “The fact that I restrict myself to what can be psychically experienced, and repudiate the metaphysical, does not mean, as anyone with insight can understand, a gesture of scepticism or agnosticism pointed against faith or trust in higher powers, but what I intend to say is approximately the same thing Kant meant when he called “*das Ding an sich*” (the thing in itself), a “purely negative, borderline concept”. Every statement about the transcendental ought to be avoided because it is invariably a laughable presumption on the part of the human mind, unconscious of its limitations“ (C. G. Jung - The Secret of The Golden Flower – p. 135).

In facing this limitation, through an empirical and pragmatic approach, Jung proposes the psychological standpoint in hopes of ending the discussion between *psyche* and matter, and finding a way of uniting this paradox. In Carl Jung’s words “I would only like to unite these extreme opposites by an *esse in anima*, which is the psychological standpoint. We live immediately only in the world of images“ (C. G. Jung - V8 – §624).

To clarify this statement, I’ve separated a very important excerpt from *Structure and Dynamics of the Psyche*, “The conflict between the physical and the spiritual aspects only shows that psychic life is in the last analysis an incomprehensible “something.” Without a doubt it is our only immediate experience. All that I experience is psychic. Even physical pain is a psychic image which I experience; my sense-impressions—for all that they force upon me a world of impenetrable objects occupying space—are psychic images, and these alone constitute my immediate experience, for they alone are the immediate objects of my consciousness. My own psyche even transforms and falsifies reality, and it does this to such a degree that I must resort to artificial means to determine what things are like apart from myself. Then I discover that a sound is a vibration of air of such and such a frequency, or that a colour is a wave of light of such and such a length. We are in truth so wrapped about by psychic images that we cannot penetrate at all to the essence of things external to ourselves. All our knowledge consists of the stuff of the psyche which, because it alone is

immediate, is superlatively real. Here, then, is a reality to which the psychologist can appeal—namely, psychic reality” (C. G. Jung - V8 - §680).

"If we try to penetrate more deeply into the meaning of this concept, it seems to us that certain psychic contents or images are derived from a “material” environment to which our bodies belong, while others, which are in no way less real, seem to come from a “spiritual” source which appears to be very different from the physical environment. Whether I picture to myself the car I wish to buy or try to imagine the state in which the soul of my dead father now is—whether it is an external fact or a thought that concerns me—both happenings are psychic reality. The only difference is that one psychic happening refers to the physical world, and the other to the spiritual world. If I shift my concept of reality on to the plane of the psyche—where alone it is valid—this puts an end to the conflict between mind and matter, spirit and nature, as contradictory explanatory principles. Each becomes a mere designation for the particular source of the psychic contents that crowd into my field of consciousness. If a fire burns me I do not question the reality of the fire, whereas if I am beset by the fear that a ghost will appear, I take refuge behind the thought that it is only an illusion. But just as the fire is the psychic image of a physical process whose nature is ultimately unknown, so my fear of the ghost is a psychic image from a spiritual source; it is just as real as the fire, for my fear is as real as the pain caused by the fire. As for the spiritual process that underlies my fear of the ghost, it is as unknown to me as the ultimate nature of matter. And just as it never occurs to me to account for the nature of fire except by the concepts of chemistry and physics, so I would never think of trying to explain my fear of ghosts except in terms of spiritual processes” (C. G. Jung - V8 - §681).

As we can see, no metaphysical question has a definite answer, as we're structurally incapable of knowing these realities for themselves. In that sense, Carl Jung adopts a rigid Kantian agnosticism, and rejects any pretensions to metaphysics, making statements exclusively in the psychological field. Therefore, when Jung speaks of God, he is not speaking of a really existent metaphysical ens, but of the *psychic image* of what constitutes the greatest amount of libido, *the highest value operative in a human soul*, the *imago Dei*. And even if this being exists, he would only be perceived psychologically, as a *psychic image*, we would never see him as he really is outside of us, only as an inner manifestation in our *psyche*. As Jung says, "There are men “whose God is the belly” (Phil. 3 : 19), and others for whom God is money, science, power, sex, etc.” (C. G. Jung - V6 - §67). Lastly, Jung summarizes this notion with the elegant and pragmatic definition that “Everything that *works*, that *affects* is real”.

1.4 - Reply To Martin Buber

Lastly, since many people have a hard time believing me and/or have certain prejudices, I want you to read these excerpts from the man himself. I'll leave a few extra quotes from one of the most important letters Jung ever wrote. In this one, he was explaining his empirical approach to Martin Buber, as he was being accused of being Gnostic and a mystic. You can find the full letter in *Symbolic Life* under the title "A Reply to Martin Buber".

Carl Jung is simply a psychiatrist:

"Now when opinions about the same subject differ so widely, there is in my view ground for the suspicion that none of them is correct, and that there has been a misunderstanding. Why is so much attention devoted to the question of whether I am a Gnostic or an agnostic? Why is it not simply stated that I am a psychiatrist whose prime concern is to record and interpret his empirical material? I try to investigate facts and make them more generally comprehensible. My critics have no right to slur over this in order to attack individual statements taken out of context" (C.G. Jung - V18 - §1500).

Facts first and theories later!

"I would like to point out to my critic that I have in my time been regarded not only as a Gnostic and its opposite, but also as a theist and an atheist, a mystic and a materialist. In this concert of contending opinions I do not wish to lay too much stress on what I consider myself to be, but will quote a judgment from a leading article in the *British Medical Journal* (9 February 1952), a source that would seem to be above suspicion. "Facts first and theories later is the keynote of Jung's work. He is an empiricist first and last." This view meets with my approval" (C.G. Jung - V18 - §1502).

Carl Jung on his empirical approach:

"Buber is mistaken in thinking that I start with a "fundamentally Gnostic viewpoint" and then proceed to "elaborate" metaphysical assertions. One should not misconstrue the findings of

empiricism as philosophical premises, for they are not obtained by deduction but from clinical and factual material” (C.G. Jung - V18 - §1510).

Carl Jung explains why he doesn't fit any system:

“It is inevitable that the adherents of traditional religious systems should find my formulations hard to understand. A Gnostic would not be at all pleased with me, but would reproach me for having no cosmogony and for the cluelessness of my gnosis in regard to the happenings in the Pleroma. A Buddhist would complain that I was deluded by Maya, and a Taoist that I was too complicated. As for an orthodox Christian, he can hardly do otherwise than deplore the nonchalance and lack of respect with which I navigate through the empyrean of dogmatic ideas. I must, however, once more beg my unmerciful critics to remember that I start from *facts* for which I seek an interpretation” (C.G. Jung - V18 - §1513).

Lastly, Carl Jung on theosophy:

"But there is still another form of negative thinking, which at first glance might not be recognized as such, and that is theosophical thinking, which today is rapidly spreading in all parts of the world, presumably in reaction to the materialism of the recent past. Theosophical thinking has an air that is not in the least reductive, since it exalts everything to a transcendental and world-embracing idea. A dream, for instance, is no longer just a dream, but an experience “on another plane.” The hitherto inexplicable fact of telepathy is very simply explained as “vibrations” passing from one person to another. An ordinary nervous complaint is explained by the fact that something has collided with the “astral body.” Certain ethnological peculiarities of the dwellers on the Atlantic seaboard are easily accounted for by the submergence of Atlantis, and so on. We have only to open a theosophical book to be overwhelmed by the realization that everything is already explained, and that “spiritual science” has left no enigmas unsolved. But, at bottom, this kind of thinking is just as negative as materialistic thinking. When the latter regards psychology as chemical changes in the ganglia or as the extrusion and retraction of cell-pseudopodia or as an internal secretion, this is just as much a superstition as theosophy. The only difference is that materialism reduces everything to

physiology, whereas theosophy reduces everything to Indian metaphysics. When a dream is traced back to an overloaded stomach, this is no explanation of the dream, and when we explain telepathy as vibrations we have said just as little. For what are “vibrations”? Not only are both methods of explanation futile, they are actually destructive, because by diverting interest away from the main issue, in one case to the stomach and in the other to imaginary vibrations, they hamper any serious investigation of the problem by a bogus explanation. Either kind of thinking is sterile and sterilizing. Its negative quality is due to the fact that it is so indescribably cheap, impoverished, and lacking in creative energy. It is a thinking taken in tow by other functions” (C.G. Jung - V6 - §594).

After this stack of undeniable truth, I hope that the nonsense can finally end. You’re welcome to have your own beliefs about life as I have mine, and I respect that. However, I hope that you understand that we can’t butcher Jung’s work to justify our personal preferences. In conclusion, Jung divides his work into two categories, *Complex Psychology* which refers to his scientific approach and *Analytical Psychology* which refers to his methodology on the therapeutic setting, both having an empirical foundation. This discussion will be amplified in the last chapter. Lastly, If you’re an epistemology nerd and want to know more, I strongly recommend reading the whole of *Psychological Types* and *Structure and Dynamics of the Psyche*. That said, now that we have the right lenses, we’re finally ready to dive deep into Carl Jung’s work.

2 - The Psychodynamics of Shadow Integration

One of the main topics that get people interested in Carl Jung is the notion of *shadow integration*, for some unknown reason it was popularized by the term *shadow work*, even though Jung never uses this term a single time. If you want to research for yourself, in Carl Jung's *collected works*, you'll find the terms *shadow assimilation* or *shadow integration*.

I wrote this segment after spending a ridiculous amount of time on Google and YouTube researching everything I could on *shadow integration*. After watching about twenty videos, something was very obvious, maybe two of them had actually read Jung, the rest were just making up the wildest stuff. The main issue is that very few people understand the crux of Jungian Psychology, i.e., *psychodynamics* and the relationship between conscious and unconscious. Also, you'll often hear people referring to "parts" or "aspects" of the personality, but no one talks about *complexes*. However, this idea is so central to Jungian Psychology that Jung himself refers to his work as *Complex Psychology*.

After this small intro, we're gonna begin by exploring Carl Jung's model of the *psyche*, a few key concepts, and finally diving deep into the process of *shadow integration*.

2.1 - Carl Jung's Model of The Psyche

Conscious Attitude

To start, we have to explore the most important concept, yet forgotten, in Jungian Psychology: *conscious attitude*. This is basically the *Modus Operandi* of an individual. In the *conscious attitude*, you'll include a belief system, values, and patterns of behavior. It's every psychological component that you use to filter and interpret your reality. Using a fancy word, your *cosmovision*.

"For us, attitude is a readiness of the psyche to act or react in a certain way [...] The state of readiness, which I conceive attitude to be, consists in the presence of a certain subjective constellation, a definite combination of psychic factors or contents, which will either determine

action in this or that definite direction, or react to an external stimulus in a definite (predetermined) way” (C. G. Jung - V6 – §687).

Another key component of someone’s *conscious attitude* is the *Psychological Types* and an Eros or Logos orientation (we’ll cover that in the *animus* and *anima* chapter). Lastly, to make things really complete, we also have to account for the *persona*. The sum of these different components will form someone’s *conscious attitude*. This may sound complex, but to make things really simple, think about your favorite character from a movie or TV show. Now, try to describe his values, beliefs, and how he tends to act in different situations. If you can spot certain patterns, you’re close to evaluating someone’s *conscious attitude*, and the *shadow integration* process will require that you study your own.

Psychodynamics

“The functional relation of the unconscious processes to consciousness may be described as compensatory, since experience shows that they bring to the surface the subliminal material that is constellated by the conscious situation, i.e., all those contents which could not be missing from the picture if everything were conscious” (C. G. Jung - V6 – §843).

Now, it’s important to understand that the *conscious attitude* acts by *selecting – directing – excluding*, and that the relationship between conscious and unconscious is *compensatory/ complementary*. In that sense, everything that is incompatible with the *conscious attitude* and its values will be relegated to the unconscious. For instance, if you’re someone extremely oriented by logic, invariably, feelings and emotions won’t be able to come to the surface, and vice-versa. In summary, everything that our conscious mind judges as bad, negative, or inferior, will form our *shadow*.

Now, it’s important to make a distinction here, because people tend to think that the *shadow* is only made of repressed stuff, however, there are things in the unconscious that were never conscious in the first place, also we have to add the collective unconscious to this equation. Plus, the prospective nature of the *psyche*, but more on that later.

The Personal and Collective Unconscious

Jung's model of the *psyche* divides the unconscious into two categories, the *personal unconscious* and the impersonal or *collective unconscious*.

The Personal Unconscious

“The Personal Unconscious contains lost memories, painful ideas that are repressed (I.e. forgotten on purpose), subliminal perceptions, by which are meant sense-perceptions that were not strong enough to reach consciousness, and finally, contents, that are not yet ripe for consciousness. It corresponds to the figure of the shadow so frequently met in dreams” (C. G. Jung - V7.1 – §103).

Unconscious contents are of a personal nature when we can recognize in our past their effects, their manifestations, and their specific origin. Lastly, the *personal shadow* is mainly made out of *complexes*.

The Collective Unconscious

In contrast, the collective unconscious consists of primordial images – *archetypes*. In summary, *archetypes* are an organizing principle principle that exists as a potential to experience something psychologically and physiologically in a similar and definite way. *Archetypes* are like a blueprint, a structure, or a pattern. They will evoke a typical thought pattern, a definite set of emotions, typical physical sensations, and definite symbolic representations. You'll find an extensive description on the *archetypes* chapter later.

2.2 - Complexes

“The tendency to split means that parts of the psyche detach themselves from consciousness to such an extent that they not only appear foreign but lead an autonomous life of their own. It need not be a question of hysterical multiple personality, or schizophrenic alterations of personality, but merely of so-called “complexes” that come entirely within the scope of the normal. Complexes are psychic

fragments which have split off owing to traumatic influences or certain incompatible tendencies“ (C. G. Jung - V8 – §253).

Recapitulating, the most important concept is *conscious attitude* and everything that is incompatible with conscious values will go to the unconscious. For the *conscious attitude* to be adaptive and contain the unconscious, it has to be one-sided, that way it can develop further. However, this is a double-edged sword, because the more one-sided the *conscious attitude* gets the less the unconscious can be expressed. The more the unconscious contents are repressed, the more *psychic energy* they acquire, until they become *complexes*.

Although *complexes* have repeating patterns and can be grouped around certain *archetypes*, like the *mother* or *father complex*, their nucleus will always be the individual experience. And that's precisely what we have to focus on when dealing with the *shadow*, even if there are *archetypes* at play, we always have to understand how they are being expressed in an individual context. That's why naming *archetypes* or intellectually learning about them is useless when dealing with the *shadow*. We have to focus on the individual experience and correcting the *conscious attitude* that's generating problems.

The Personified Unconscious

“[...] For fundamentally there is no difference in principle between a fragmentary personality and a complex“ (C. G. Jung - V8 – §202).

As we've seen, *complexes* are autonomous. We tend to refer to them as “parts” or “aspects” of our personality, because the nature of the unconscious is to be personified. An interesting thing to add here is that we also experience the four functions and the *animus* and *anima* as *complexes*. A modern example of the effects of a *complex* is Bruce Banner and The Hulk. Bruce Banner aligns with the *introverted thinking type*. Plus, he has a very timid, quiet, and cowardly attitude. Naturally, this attitude would repress any expression of emotion and aggression. Hence, the Hulk, a giant impulsive and fearless beast fueled by rage.

The Right Attitude

“We know that the mask of the unconscious is not rigid—it reflects the face we turn towards it. Hostility lends it a threatening aspect, friendliness softens its features” (C. G. Jung - V12 – §29).

But here we have to take a step back because it's easy to think that *complexes* are bad and evil and pathologize them. In fact, everyone has *complexes* and this is totally normal, there's no need to panic. What makes them bad is our conscious judgments. We always have to remember that the unconscious reacts to our *conscious attitude*. In other words, our attitude towards the unconscious will determine how we experience a *complex*.

For instance, any expression of anger tends to be quickly judged as the works of satan, that's why most people do everything they can to repress it, and the more we repress something the more it rebels against us. That's why when it finally encounters an outlet it's this huge possessive thing. When it's finally over, we're left with shame and regret. In reality, we must cultivate an open mind towards the unconscious and seek to see both sides of any aspect. Too much anger obviously can be destructive, however, when it's properly channeled it can give us the ability to say no, place healthy boundaries, and provide us with the courage to end relationships that aren't healthy.

When we allow one-sided judgments to rule our *psyche*, even the most positive trait can be experienced as something destructive. Nowadays, most people run away from their creativity because they think "It doesn't serve to anything", or "It's not practical and it's such a waste of time". As a result, most people feel dry and uninspired, because they can't let go, they have to be in control and rational all the time. The secret is to establish a relationship with these forsaken parts and seek a way of giving them a healthy expression. We achieve that by transforming our *conscious attitude*, this is the main objective of good psychotherapy. The problem isn't the *shadow*, but how we perceive it. Therefore, the goal of *shadow integration* is to embody these parts in our personality and exert them in a conscious way. Because when these unconscious aspects can't find a way of being consciously expressed, they can turn into symptoms.

The Puppet Masters

“The *via regia* to the unconscious [...] is the complex, which is the architect of dreams and of symptoms” (C. G. Jung - V8 – §210).

Complexes are the real puppet masters behind every symptom and we can see its effects whenever we overreact to something when we're taken by a sudden rage, anxiety, and even depression. As *complexes* can be grouped around certain patterns and *archetypes*, the most interesting thing is that they can produce typical thought and emotional, physical, and symbolic patterns. They are the sum of all experiences around a theme, like the *mother* and *father complex*. Also, *complexes* are the characters we see during our dreams, portraying our own psychological tendencies.

The crazy thing is that while *complexes* are unconscious, they have no relationship with the ego, so they can feel like a foreign body, something completely external pulling the strings. In some cases, this dissociation is so severe, that people believe it's an outside spirit controlling them. In *Structure and Dynamics of The Psyche*, Jung says that “Spirits, therefore, viewed from the psychological angle, are unconscious autonomous complexes which appear as projections because they have no direct association with the ego” (C. G. Jung - V8 – §585).

The Complex System

The most important thing to understand about *complexes* is that they distort our interpretation of reality and produce specific narratives. In that sense, *neurosis* means that a *complex* is ruling the conscious mind, now, you get trapped in a system and a storyline. *Complexes* have the power to shape our identity and consequently our whole lives. For instance, let's take someone whose identity revolves around a victim complex. This person will fabricate an illusory narrative that “No one suffers like them” and “Nothing ever works for them”. They will start acting like that overly sensitive spoiled little kid, always complaining, and demanding that people cater to his every need. If you refuse to enable them, they throw a huge fit.

Now, *complexes* have a compulsive quality and will seek to recreate the same pattern over and over again. This means that this person will actively seek to place themselves in situations where they can be perceived as a victim. They will constantly harbor depressive feelings that prevent them from taking action, just like that kid who pretends to be sick to avoid going to school. When you come up with solutions, they quickly find every excuse imaginable trying to justify why this won't work. They romanticize their own suffering because it gives them an illusory sense of uniqueness. They think that they're so special that the world can't understand them and common solutions are beneath them.

In reality, they don't want it to work, they hang on to every excuse imaginable to avoid growing up, because while they are a victim, there's always someone to blame for their shortcomings. While they play the victim card, they can secretly tyrannize everyone and avoid taking responsibility for their lives. This is so insidious, that they will shape every relationship they have with this same dynamic, and will even refuse to acknowledge positive qualities about themselves. Why? ... Because this would change their identity, once you own positive traits, it becomes your duty to exert them in a conscious way.

In the end, you have to ask yourself brutally honest questions:

- In which areas am I avoiding taking responsibility?
- How many obstacles and excuses am I fabricating in order to remain childish?
- Why do I want to seek labels of ineptitude?

The more you take ownership, the more you see yourself capable of taking agency. Looking for possibilities instead of obstacles changes everything.

The Most Powerful Question

Well, it's obviously important to try to understand the story behind these patterns and we often devote a great time during therapy doing that. But without looking at the present moment and how we can move forward, this often gets people stuck in the past. In fact, many people get obsessed, because no "why" is ever satisfying enough. Going to the past is only half of the equation, now, we're adults and we have to move forward. That's why one of the most powerful questions we can ask is:

How am I contributing to this dynamic?

We just explored how *complexes* create an intricate system of thoughts, feelings, fantasies, and behaviors. If you find yourself living the same situations over and over again, it's because an unconscious part of you is fueling this dynamic. That's why you have to study your own system and ask yourself how you've been contributing to keeping this narrative alive. Most of the time we hang on to *complexes* in order to avoid change and take on new responsibilities. We avoid facing that we're the ones producing our own suffering. Yes, I know it's painful, but this realization can set you free. The *shadow integration* process demands that we take full responsibility for our lives, and in doing so, we open the possibility of writing new stories.

3 - The Puer and Puella Aeternus

In the next few chapters, I'd like to devote some time to explore one of the main problems of our *zeitgeist*, many people have been refusing to grow up and have been remaining childish for too long. Marie Von Franz foresaw this issue in the 70's with her incredible book, "*The Problem of The Puer Aeternus*". This is one of those books that can completely change your life if you apply its knowledge, and since I read it, my life took on a new course and I was finally able to truly grow up.

As you may notice, this is a subject very dear to my heart, since it mingles with my personal story. I dare to say that, in people under 40, 90% of their psychological problems stem from avoiding truly becoming an adult and fully taking responsibility for their lives. And I even analyzed people approaching their 50s still dealing with this very same problem. That's why I felt the duty to share everything I've personally learned from overcoming this condition and all the insights I've gained after having analyzed people from over twenty different countries. I started sharing these articles on Reddit and since then I've received messages on a weekly basis seeking guidance on how to overcome this, so now I present you with the *Conquer The Puer and Puella Aeternus Series*.

3.1 - The Mother and Father Complex - The Journey To Adulthood

The Call To Adventure

The first task of every person is to be able to free themselves from the protection of their mother and father and take their call to adventure. However, in order to do so we must draw our sword and kill the dragon of desire for eternal childhood and develop authority, independence, and responsibility for our own lives.

The Archetypal Principles

The *mother* and *father complexes* are, arguably, the two archetypal principles that have the most influence over our *psyche*. Jung says that "The father acts as a protection against the dangers of the external world and thus serves his son as a model persona, so the mother protects him against the dangers that threaten from the darkness of his psyche. In the puberty rites, therefore, the initiate

receives instruction about these things of “the other side,” so that he is put in a position to dispense with his mother’s protection” (C. G. Jung - V7 – §315).

The mother is the embodiment of the collective unconscious and represents the Eros principle, the sensual and chthonic realm, pleasure, and nourishment. From the unconscious springs our life force, creativity, and the possibility for renewal and rebirth. The mother opens the possibility for a relationship with our inner world and our *soul*. This principle also determines how we relate to our emotions and build relationships.

In contrast, the father embodies the Logos principle and the spiritual realm. It’s about authority, responsibility, tradition, and preservation. He is the law and that’s why he balances the instinctual tendency of the unconscious. The father opens the possibility to develop our *persona* and our relationship with the external world. “The father represents the world of moral commandments and prohibitions [...] The father is the representative of the spirit, whose function it is to oppose pure instinctuality. That is his archetypal role, which falls to him regardless of his personal qualities; hence he is very often an object of neurotic fears for the son” (C. G. Jung - V5 – §396).

Both principles balance one another and an exacerbation to any side will invariably lead to problems. To make things very simple, for both men and women, too much of the father principle kills absolutely everything that’s related to the feminine principle, and too much of the mother principle kills every quality of the father principle.

The Inner Theatre

“Interpretation in terms of the parents is, however, simply a *façon de parler*. In reality the whole drama takes place in the individual’s own *psyche*, where the “parents” are not the parents at all but only their imagos: they are representations which have arisen from the conjunction of parental peculiarities with the individual disposition of the child” (C. G. Jung - V5 – §505).

Although these principles are internal forces, they are projected upon the real mother and father, or the caregivers that adopted this role in your life. We first experience these two forces through them and this will shape how we relate to these principles internally. Therefore individual

experience can act like gatekeepers to creating a healthy relationship with these principles and preventing a person from growing up.

What Does It Mean To Be Infantile?

“An individual is infantile because he has freed himself insufficiently, or not at all, from his childish environment and his adaptation to his parents, with the result that he has a false reaction to the world: on the one hand he reacts as a child towards his parents, always demanding love and immediate emotional rewards, while on the other hand he is so identified with his parents through his close ties with them that he behaves like his father or his mother. He is incapable of living his own life and finding the character that belongs to him” (C. G. Jung - V5 – §431).

Another kind of infantilism is when someone is able to acquire some adaptation to outer life but remains childish when it comes to emotions. We have plenty of examples in tv-shows like Frasier, Chandler from Friends, or the character Sheldon from the Big Bang Theory. “So far as his emotional life is concerned, he has not yet caught up with himself, as is often the case with people who are apparently so masterful towards life and their fellows, but who have remained infantile in regard to the demands of feeling” (C. G. Jung - V5 – §431).

Therefore an individual is childish when he’s determined by their parent’s expectations and beliefs. He has an artificial adaptation to life because he’s unconsciously reacting to the world just like his parents would. This tends to appear in mainly two ways, either the person is absorbed by their beliefs and seeks to perpetuate them, or the person might rebel against everything and seek to do the exact opposite. In either case, he’s not an individual and has no life of his own, he’s fate is determined by the idea of his inner parents.

The *parental complex* is about authority, independence and autonomy, and everything starts by understanding how you relate to these principles within. For instance, imagine a person that is repulsed by the idea he has about his father “because he’s such a tyrant”. Furthermore, this person is constantly getting in trouble with authority figures and sees himself as a rebel. Well, chances are that this person has an inner tyrant and also acts in the exact same manner, but is unconscious of it.

Not only that, but this person is also the first prey of this inner tyrant. However, when something is projected it exempts us from dealing with the truth, that what's projected, in reality, lives within. And all this hatred will prevent you from relating to this principle in a healthy way because ultimately, you're hating this in yourself. However, in order to conquer the *complex*, you must take responsibility for it. The adult is the one that mastered these two principles within and was able to create a relationship with them free from parental influence.

Relationships

These internal dynamics appear especially in relationships because you'll project your inner *mother* and *father complex* on others, and mainly on your partner. Imagine that person who has a poor relationship with his emotions, invariably, they will project this function onto their partner. This person will delegate the responsibility for their emotional life and now the other person has to care for them and provide absolutely everything, just like a mother has to do for her baby. Not only that, if this isn't done exactly how they want it, all the blame will fall on their partner. This kind of person sucks the life out of everyone. But never forget, relationship dynamics are only formed because both parties are performing their role. In the aforementioned case, for instance, there's also an enabler who usually adopts the position of the helper.

This also tends to happen a lot with figures of authority, like a boss or a teacher you admire. Let's say your experience with your real father was frustrating, he was always dismissive and overly critical. This tends to create an internal void that's constantly seeking validation. Furthermore, you can internalize this inner critic and now it has nothing to do with the real father, you start doing this to yourself. Now imagine that a person is unconsciously seeing his internal father projected onto his boss, in this moment, this person will react to them exactly as he would to his real father. Let's say the boss is trying to be helpful with some constructive criticism. Now, *complexes* always distort reality and amplify emotional reactions, they make us interpret things that aren't necessarily happening. This moment might trigger this internal father, the inner critic, and the terrible feelings associated with it. Suddenly, you're acting and feeling like a helpless child. But always remember that, even though it was triggered in relation to someone else, this lives within.

Responsibility

In every case, tracing the origins of certain behaviors will almost always lead to the relationship with the caregivers. There will always be the tendency of looking for someone to blame, but in doing so you're simply avoiding dealing with the real matter and perpetuating a childish existence. I get it, you might have gone through horrible and despicable things and none of this was fair and they weren't your fault. And I know it hurts, but now you're an adult and you have everything you need to turn your life around. It can be scary and overwhelming taking responsibility but this also gives you power. You'll never be able to change what happened or other people, but you can change how you experience everything internally and this will set you free.

Psychological knowledge is a double-edged sword, some people use it to perpetuate even more their childish behaviors, but the wise ones see it as a map to better understand themselves and do everything they can to change. Most of our problems stem from remaining a child psychologically for too long, it ruins relationships and brings anxiety and depression. Carl Jung says that "The perpetual hesitation of the neurotic to launch out into life is readily explained by his desire to stand aside so as not to get involved in the dangerous struggle for existence. But anyone who refuses to experience life must stifle his desire to live—in other words, he must commit partial suicide" (C. G. Jung - V5 – §165).

Here we see people using every excuse and creating scenarios where they can be perceived as victims so other people become responsible for them. But while you refuse to take life by its horns, I'm sorry to tell you, but all you'll be able to see is darkness. Or perhaps you're just floating in a bubble that's about to pop, it's a half-life that I don't wish for anyone. Listen to that voice that wants more and that wants to conquer life. Take your call to adventure, the dragon you must kill lives within. It's time to let go of your childishness, because every time you hesitate this dragon gains power. Commit to living life. Remember this is a process, take one step at a time, you might fall, but that's ok. Be gentle with yourself and pick yourself up. Lastly, don't underestimate the power of decisiveness and small increments, that's how significant changes come to be.

But what happens when you hesitate to become an adult and allow the dragon to win? Well, this takes us to the problem of the *Puer Aeternus*.

3.2 - Conquer The Puer and Puella Aeternus

“Life calls us forth to independence, and anyone who does not heed this call because of childish laziness or timidity is threatened with neurosis. And once this has broken out, it becomes an increasingly valid reason for running away from life and remaining forever in the morally poisonous atmosphere of infancy” (C. G. Jung - V5 – §461).

The condition of the *Puer* or *Puella Aeternus* can be easily described as a general fear of life and avoidance of responsibility. They are the child of the promise and are full of potential, however, they refuse their task. There's a poignant illusion that the fantasy world is better than reality, even though they secretly know that this is just a maneuver to remain childish. However, having one foot in the eternal childhood paradise gives them a very youthful energy and fills them with creativity, inspiration, and a certain brightness.

They tend to be full of ideals and know everything that's wrong with society. When they look at adults all they can see are people trapped “in the system”. They are the ones that know better! Everything that resembles responsibilities and commitments seems terrifying. They feel trapped, but it's only because this confronts their childishness. The result is a *provisional life*.

There's a constant longing for the perfect thing and waiting for the perfect conditions. They are constantly trying to build sand castles on a windy beach. When everything falls apart they look for someone to blame, when in reality, they never commit to anything long enough and never go all in. Many fall on the perfectionism side, but this is only a protection against an imaginary failure. “If I never try I can't ever fail”. This mingles with procrastination, as a result, they are constantly stuck.

Others expect to be great at something without even dedicating themselves to it. They refuse to pay the price to achieve any kind of greatness, and as soon as it gets difficult they abandon everything. But this shouldn't matter, after all, they're constantly substituting reality with their fantasies. And in fantasy land, they can continue dreaming about everything they want to achieve and never do anything. Everything is a maneuver to stay in this stagnant endless loop and avoid dealing with reality. They are hostages to their own fantasies and little do they know that real life can set them free, because it's in reality that their fantasies must be given shape and be concretized.

A lot of them are extremely smart and love “deep conversations”, but there’s a huge problem. They only understand things on an intellectual level. There’s no action and experience behind it, it’s a half-knowledge that has no life. Deep down, they are huge hypocrites, because their ideals do not hold up in reality and they’re too afraid to face the world and actually live by them. The *Puer* and *Puella* always choose “the easy way out” and tend to create conditions where they can be perceived as a victim, so others take responsibility for them. In this process, they can put their own family or friends through a living hell. But obviously, the problem is never in themselves, it’s always the parents who didn’t love them enough or weren’t able to give them everything they wanted. Alternatively, they blame “the system” and the inability of other people to see how amazing they are.

Here we arrive at one of the most important elements: Everyone believes that they know their parents, or their caregivers, extremely well, but this couldn’t be further from the truth! This relationship is mediated by an archetypal projection that evokes a cloud of misjudgments. More often than not, you’re projecting your own inabilities onto the parents. Once again, this is another maneuver to avoid dealing with reality, because while something is projected you can exempt yourself from dealing with the fact, that in reality, everything lives within. “Oh but you don’t know my mother, she’s so devouring!” Here’s the thing, she might objectively have these traits. However, this only has an overbearing effect because this triggers something within. Remember that *complexes* always amplify emotional reactions and they intervene in our interpretation of reality. In that way, you have to realize that you’re allowing her to have this much power over you. Because actually, you’re the one devouring yourself when you refuse to grow and take responsibility.

Relationships

The *Puer* love is always self-centered and narcissistic as he never loves the real person, only his projection. He loves what the person can give him and how the other person makes him feel. Everything is about him, he loves being in love because once again he’s abducted by his fantasies, in this intoxication, he can forget about the real world. But it’s all empty, the other person is just a means to an end. As soon as his ideal of perfection starts being challenged, there’s a huge backlash or he simply vanishes. Needless to say he also has a huge fear of commitment, he never creates a real bond and is constantly avoiding seeing the reality of the other person. He abandons everyone

first because, in reality, he never committed in the first place. Once again he weeps and blames the world and Limerence becomes one of the most powerful drugs.

If he manages to be in a relationship it's always tinged by codependency, and every toxic relationship is fueled by huge projections and conflating validation with love. In the first case, the *Puer* or *Puella* are constantly seeking his mother or father in his relationships. In the second, he avoids the matter completely and creates an intellectual shield, where feelings don't stand a chance and his sexuality is sacrificed. In both cases, the libido remains attached to the mother or father, or better put, it remains attached to his fantastical "*Never Land*".

The Dark Side

"The perpetual hesitation of the neurotic to launch out into life is readily explained by his desire to stand aside so as not to get involved in the dangerous struggle for existence. But anyone who refuses to experience life must stifle his desire to live—in other words, he must commit partial suicide" (C. G. Jung - V5 – §165).

The incessant search to keep his fantasies alive can also turn poisonous very quickly. Here we arrive at the most critical element: *The one that refuses to live is already partially dead*. The longing for paradise and eternal mother also mingles with a constant flirt with death. Here, vices, self-destructing habits, reckless behaviors, and porn addiction can all be means to perpetuate this state of unconsciousness and avoidance. When this is coupled with new-age beliefs or nihilism a whole new clusterfuck arises and opens the door to psychosis. Beliefs like "We only have the now", "Everything is transient", "The real world is an illusion", "Nothing matters", "I must kill my ego", etc. You get the idea.

Well, spirituality and philosophy can be great if you have roots in reality, they help you find meaning, but not for the *Puer* and *Puella*. These ideas can fuel an elaborate scheme that justifies their refusal to take responsibility for their lives, and even psychology can serve this purpose. The results are depression, anxiety, and even death fantasies. Sadly, many succumb to it. There's a tendency to romanticize death and suffering. Some use this as a means to call attention and manipulate, and some to reaffirm their state, because, in that way, they will never need to grow.

The Sacrifice

“This sacrifice means giving up the connection with the mother, relinquishing all the ties and limitations which the psyche has taken over from childhood into adult life. It is not possible to live too long amid infantile surroundings, or in the bosom of the family, without endangering one’s psychic health” (C. G. Jung - V5 – §461).

The *Puer* and *Puella* tell the story of an unrealized potential and a half-lived life. Healing lies in facing reality and fully committing to living life. But in order to do so, they must let go of their fantasies of being a misunderstood genius or a special snowflake, the internalized megalomania and sense of entitlement must be completely eradicated. Instead, they must learn to accept full responsibility for their actions and learn that everything has a price to be paid. Meaningful work and responsibility are the principles that can redeem their soul. Bringing their dreams to reality and fighting for them is what can revitalize their spirit. Realizing their potential and fulfilling their role as the child of the promise is what can bring meaning to their existence.

I know I said extremely harsh things, but this comes from someone that cares deeply and wants you to conquer your life. As I therapist I always find myself in a very tricky position, with each person, there’s a fine balance between validating and challenging them to grow. I know I will receive every projection imaginable and will be expected to magically cure, but nothing can happen if the person doesn’t commit to life first. Once this is done, I celebrate with them every small step in the direction of the lives they ought to be living. The journey to redeem our souls ain’t easy, but it’s in this journey that lies what we’re truly seeking. Take your call to adventure. Don’t know where to start? “*Where your fear is there’s your task*” - C G. Jung.

3.3 - Meaningful Work

In the previous chapter, I mentioned *meaningful work* as a solution to the *Puer* problem. But this tends to evoke a lot of confusion, especially the *meaningful* part. Some people, as soon as they hear the word “work” picture someone selling their souls and completely giving up on their hopes and dreams. They envision someone slaving themselves for thirty-plus years in a dead-end corporate job, absolutely dreading their existence. That made me realize that this topic must be expanded with some validated advice, so here’s my attempt to fill in some gaps.

Independence

Let's recap the most important lines on this matter:

“The *Puer* and *Puella* tell the story of an unrealized potential and a half-lived life. Meaningful work and responsibility are the principles that can redeem their soul. Bringing their dreams to reality and fighting for them is what can revitalize their spirit. Realizing their potential and fulfilling their role as the child of the promise is what can bring meaning to their existence”.

The *Puer* and *Puella* tend to have a very distorted and negative relationship with work. It evokes the feeling of being trapped because once again it threatens their clinging to childhood. However, work is exactly what can set them free. It's one of the pillars of conquering authority over one's life, it's the price you pay for acquiring autonomy and freedom to be and act according to your own essence. Through hard work, one can turn their deepest aspirations into concrete reality. It propels the creation of a life imbued with meaning, and inspiration, and that's worth living. Without seeking independence it's just impossible to free yourself from parental influence, and the one that refuses this task will be forever doomed to live in their shadow. The results as we already know are chaotic relationships, depression, anxiety, and a lack of meaning and direction.

Main Patterns

Over the years I noticed two main patterns. The first one is the *Puer* or *Puella* that jumps from job to job every three months, as soon as things start to get more serious their “free-spirited souls” just vanish seeking the next “perfect” job. The second kind is more subtle. There's a tendency to be accommodated in a very low-effort job that has absolutely no challenges. Nevertheless, this conceals a deep fear of pursuing their true aspirations. Another variant is the ones that seek to make a living in excuse ways, always trying to bend the law. In all cases, *meaning* and commitment to their true path are missing. But let's say they understand the importance of seeking their autonomy, now what?

Meaningful Work

The *Puer* and *Puella* always have one foot in the realm of the eternal fountain of youth. This gives them brightness, insightfulness, and the ability to draw inspiration and creativity directly from the *collective unconscious*. This is only insidious when it's not rooted in reality, because when this creative force isn't elaborated and doesn't find its place in reality, it rots and drags the *Puer* along with it. Then he falls prey to a myriad of fantasies and wishful thinking, never accomplishing anything. It's as if he's living in a glass castle that prevents him from fully engaging with life.

However, when this connection is paired with responsibility and adaptation to life, wonderful creations can come to fruition. Simply put, the *Puer* and *Puella* have to find a way of maintaining their connection with creativity and inspiration while they grow up. These forces spring from the *Self*, however, what's determinant is what you do with it. It's their mission to shape this inspiration and give it a place in reality. The first lesson the *Puer* and *Puella* ought to embody is that everything has a price and even the most wonderful endeavors, have their hardships.

Here I can share a personal example. I firmly believe that my *soul* called me to pursue the path I'm on. This calling turned into the responsibility of paying the price for making it happen. It's in practical life that you must create a *vessel* for your fantasies to be expressed. Planning a career change, countless hours of studying, and investing in proper training and analysis is what I paid for following my *soul*. This will require diligence, discipline, and the creation of new habits. This path made me face every fear I had, in reality, things aren't easier because you're following your inspiration, but it allows you to build an unshakable foundation. By engaging with your *soul* your sense of *meaning* is unraveled. But It's not something static, *meaning* happens and is experienced within the relationship with your *soul*. Meaning has to be created ever anew with each step you take in the direction of what inspires and realizes you. A true sense of *inspiration* and *meaning* are only unraveled when you go beyond the ego and break free from arrogant selfish pursuits and the quest for power, and you put yourself at the service of the *Self*.

Inspiration

“Everything you said seems amazing, but I don’t feel inspired at all!” Usually, inspiration is buried under the parental complex. In other words, you allow their expectations to define you. You’re so enmeshed in their value system that it prevents you from freely accessing your *soul*. However, this is usually coupled with fear of admitting to oneself what one truly wants, because once you do, then you’ll have to do something about it and you won’t have the parental excuse anymore.

Many illusions are fabricated in this process, and people end up pursuing things to seek validation or to prove someone wrong. Or even that they are going all in into something when they truly aren’t. Deep down, it’s all an attempt to escape their own *souls* and avoid their true task. Another possibility is that you’re so detached from the practical aspects of life that your inspiration can’t reach reality. In this case, once you start taking more steps toward your independence, inspiration tends to fall into place. But I will elaborate on this a bit further as there’s one unspoken danger we have to address.

The Curse of Enantiodromia

Many *Puers* and *Puellas*, once they finally commit to a career path, face the curse of *enantiodromia*. In other words, they become a disillusioned and grumpy “adult”. Notice the quotation marks, because in this case the *Puer* ends up acquiring an artificial adaptation, but remains emotionally childish. The *shadow* simply engulfs them, also stealing every good quality the *Puer* has. For some, this is a necessary evil in their journeys, because once they’re able to bring their inspiration back it finds a more mature *vessel*. With their new sense of autonomy and responsibility, they can safely reconnect with the fantastical realm without being engulfed by it. Thus they can begin their process of creating *meaning*.

The Parental Shadow

“But the real therapy only begins when the patient sees that it is no longer father and mother who are standing in his way, but himself—i.e., an unconscious part of his personality which carries on the role of father and mother” (C. G. Jung - V7 – §88).

In reality, the *Puer* problem is multifaceted and it's impossible to address all its variants in a single chapter. However, there's always one constant, the influence of the *parental complex*. In other words, he unconsciously behaves like his father or mother and reacts to the world as if he were still a child. In fact, many are able to commit to a career and build a family, but it's only an artificial adaptation as they are still children internally. This appears in their relationships when they expect to be mothered or fathered by their partners, or when they refuse to have emotional responsibility over their relationship and act like giant narcissistic babies.

Career-wise, many will seek the approval of their parents. Others might rebel and go for exactly what their parents hate, but it's not for them, it's a choice made out of spite. An interesting variant are the ones that try to escape their mothers by going to an intellectual field, and I met many of them back in the day when I was in college. They will spend years seeking a master's and even a PhD, but they have zero life experience. They are intellectually bright but clueless when it comes to emotions and relationships.

It's also true that many are able to build discipline and diligence, but it's often not directed to the right place. It lacks the most important part, connecting with life. During music school, I met many bright musicians, but they always hesitated to go on crucial gigs. I know this because I've already done it too, haha. Many live in an illusion where they are going all in, but they are always finding a way to deviate and have the perfect excuse for doing so.

When the *Puer* and *Puella* have kids, they never get fully involved and refuse to adopt the role of the adult. It's like they are “buddies”. They might treat their kids exactly like their parents treated them, or they will seek to do the exact opposite. Needless to say, everything is made in reaction to their parents, there is no individual character. In the worst scenarios, they are the ones who behave like children and expect their kids to be their parents.

As you can see, *meaningful work* is a crucial pillar for having your independence. However, the matter goes deeper. It all starts with challenging your identification with the belief system of the parents and stepping out of their shadow. Responsibility isn't just about maintaining external conditions, it involves seeking your individuality and building a new attitude toward life. It's about finding your own sense of *meaning* and committing to your task. It's about giving your blood and fully engaging with absolutely everything you do. Regardless if it's an individual pursuit, your relationships, or your creativity.

The Life Puzzle

In this final part, I'll share some validated practical advice that I always explore with my patients:

So how can one maintain his connection with the eternal source while growing up?

I strongly recommend finding something that allows you to be creative and commit to it. It really doesn't matter what it is, as long as it nurtures your *soul*, because this is exactly what might sustain you during this process. Once you establish this connection, I see two main alternatives, and it's really important that you understand the kind of relationship you built with your practice. Either you can bring this to a profession or maintain it as a source of inspiration.

Here's what I mean by that, before I became a therapist, I graduated in music and I worked for many years teaching and playing music. However, the pressure to turn music into a profession completely took the joy out of it, and everything became very mechanical and about achieving perfection. What inspired me completely rot. There was even a period where I completely disconnected from it and dabbled with weird jobs, until I finally understood that this was not the relationship I was supposed to have with music, its place in my life is a source of inspiration.

In contrast, psychology fulfills the professional role. This allows me to freely engage with music and explore my creativity, and all the inspiration I get from it is also directed to my work. It's important to realize that your sense of inspiration might not come directly or solely from your work. For instance, having a symbolic attitude toward music allows me to bring it to a psychological level

and this opens the possibility to a deeper understanding of creativity, inspiration, the *anima* and the feeling realm, and even my fears, and all of this makes me a better therapist.

Understanding the relationship and the place each thing has in your life is extremely powerful. So It's ok to have a job you're good enough at, but you don't love, it will give you the freedom and foundation to pursue the other parts of the puzzle, such as meaningful relationships and your connection with the *eternal source*. Here, I can recommend a great book called "The Creative Act: A Way of Being" by Rick Rubin.

Many people also get surprised along the way when they uncover new talents and aspirations, and having that boring job is exactly what sustains them in these new endeavors. Even if you don't have any inspiration now, take any step you can toward your freedom. Do it for your *soul* and you'll find yourself along the way. Now is the time to drag yourself out off the couch, or perhaps you've already done that, but everything was under the shadow of the *parental complex*, and now it's important to take some time to reassess your life and uncover your individuality.

Always remember to seek a balance between the mother and father aspect. Regardless, dare to realize your authentic path. In Joseph Campbell's words: "If you can see your path laid out in front of you step by step, you know it's not your path. Your own path you make with every step you take. That's why it's your path".

3.4 - The Invaluable Mission of the Puer and Puella Aeternus

Through the years, I've noticed that most people can only appreciate the *Puer Aeternus* in a negative way, that's why I'd like to explore this matter through a final angle: *The invaluable mission of the Puer and Puella Aeternus*.

You see, every psychological process of transformation begins with the *Puer Aeternus*. Why?... Because it's the seed of new life. It's pure potential. Its appearance brings a myriad of unheard possibilities and uncharted pathways. When everything feels stuck and the *conscious attitude* has reached its limit, that's when the *Puer* energy is needed, as it unblocks a brand-new

understanding, and life can flow again. In other words, the *Puer* and *Puella Aeternus* have the mission to bring renewal.

We can see that when they question and challenge old ways of doing things. When they call out religions for imposing outdated values, or when they call out politicians for being narrow-minded. But my favorite example is about mental health, at least in my country, people above fifty, generally speaking, still think that doing therapy is for the weak or crazy people, and this is something we definitely don't see with the younger generations. For the record, I wish I wasn't operating with these prejudices in my early 20's, things would have been so much easier, haha.

Anyway, here's where everything becomes critical, because in this pursuit to challenge tradition and culture, the *Puer* and *Puella* tend to be consumed by their childishness and power hunger. Here's where they will start imagining an idealized fantastical realm and flee from the real world. Instead of capitalizing on their potential, they become masters of playing the victim card. Instead of fighting for their ideals and contributing to a positive change, they succumb to their sense of entitlement, pride, and start oppressing everyone. An enantiodromia happens. In the place of renewal, they bring destruction. In the place of a new path, chaos ensues. They lose hope, because the one that refuses to engage with real life is already partially dead. So what then? This sense of purpose and meaningfulness only comes when you accept life as it is. It's hidden underneath egoic and selfish pursuits and it's unraveled when you engage with your soul. It only emerges when you accept full responsibility.

After analyzing people from over twenty different countries, I've encountered two major tendencies. Either people feel incapable of holding their true purpose because they feel like it's beyond them, and this was definitely me at some point, or they judge it as something bad or inferior. A combination is also possible as both are a maneuver to avoid committing to it. In the first case, it's imperative to strengthen the ego-complex so the person can take ownership of their mission. In the second, we have to understand the story behind why they have these judgments and what's their purpose. Usually, they're operating through someone else's values and/ or they're too enmeshed in our *zeitgeist* and haven't uncovered their own *cosmovision* and value system. That's where Jungian Analysis can be really valuable to someone's journey.

The *Puer* and *Puella* really ought to learn how to place their ideals in real life and live by them, they need to get their hands dirty and bring this transformation forth. When you engage with the *soul*, life acquires a new sense of purposefulness. Every action feels like you're putting together the greatest piece of art. In this process, every excuse imaginable appears, but in the end, you're just running away from your *soul*. Every illusion must be sacrificed as this is the only way to produce something that's truly valuable, and don't be fooled, you won't be doing this solely to you, this isn't a selfish pursuit. Every individual transformation requires that you pay your tribute to the world. Yes, this will require courage as *following one's soul is the greatest audacity*.

4 - The Psychological Types Unraveled

In the second chapter, we explored Carl Jung's model of the *psyche* and I introduced you to *psychodynamics*. If you were paying attention, here's the moment of the truth, you'll remember that I said that the most important concept in Jungian Psychology is *attitude*. This is basically how a person is wired, their basic tendencies, and patterns of behavior, how one tends to interpret, filter, and react to the world. You can also add someone's beliefs, political views, philosophy of life, habits, and everything they've learned from their personal story. The sum of these different components forms someone's *conscious attitude*.

However, behind all of these individual tendencies, Jung discovered a system that's common to everyone – *The Psychological Types*, the foundation of someone's *conscious attitude*. Personally, I consider this method the ultimate compass for our psychological development. It can give us immense clarity about how to harmonize our strengths and weaknesses, and invaluable insights to navigate our relationships. Before I jump into it, I wanna be very clear that pure types don't exist, we'll be exploring basic patterns and tendencies and people will fall on a spectrum: "Naturally, they [*psychological types*] never occur, in reality, in their pure form, but always and only with individual variations derived from the principle that governs its appearance, similar to the crystals, which generally, are variants of the same system" (C. G. Jung - V8 - §221).

Lastly, you might have encountered several tests on the internet claiming to reveal your typology, but let me tell you that every time I see that I can hear Carl Jung rolling in his grave. Since he isn't alive to protest, I'll try to explain why these tests are a scam. The first thing is that typology isn't something static, it evolves and changes as we mature psychologically, it's not something deterministic or characterological, this is not bad astrology. We've established that pure types don't exist, so trying to fit someone into a fixed category is just completely ignoring someone's individuality.

Furthermore, a test would never be able to capture the complexity of the *psychodynamics* involved. People seldom have an objective perspective about themselves, and more often than not, they give answers that have nothing to do with their true personalities, the unconscious and the *inferior function* are constantly interjecting. As aforementioned, what's possible is to delineate a

few basic tendencies, knowing that people will express them in a myriad of ways. That said, it's time to explore these basic patterns.

4.1 - Introversion and Extraversion

The first component of the *psychological types* is introversion and extraversion: “[...] A habitual attitude in which one of the mechanisms will predominate, without, however, being able to completely suppress the other, as this is a necessary part of psychic activity. That is why there cannot be a pure type in the sense of having only one of the mechanisms [...] A typical attitude always and only means the relative predominance of one of the mechanisms” (C. G. Jung - V6 - §6).

The first thing we have to understand about introversion and extraversion is that this isn't static, it's fluid, there isn't someone 100% introverted or extraverted all of the time. What we have is the relative predominance of one of the mechanisms. You know when someone says that they're generally introverted but extremely extroverted with people they know more intimately? That's why. Also, we might experience certain periods in our lives where one of the mechanics is more prevalent than the other. This doesn't make you an “ambivert”, as there's no such thing, this is just another lack of understanding of *psychodynamics*. Being an introvert or extravert is a way of relating to and understanding the world, and the biggest difference lies in the relationship with objects.

“ [...] In the extravert, the libido habitually flows consciously toward the object, but there is also an unconscious secret counteraction back toward the subject. For the extravert the hidden move toward the subject is usually an unconscious factor. In the case of the introvert, the opposite occurs, for he feels as if an object would constantly overwhelm him, so that he has to continually retire from it, for everything is falling upon him, he is constantly overwhelmed by impressions, but he is unaware that he is secretly borrowing, or lending, psychic energy to the object through his own unconscious extraversion” (Marie Von Franz - Psychotherapy - p. 27).

Now, we're gonna explore both tendencies more in-depth.

Extraverts

"Now, when orientation by the object predominates in such a way that decisions and actions are determined not by subjective views but by objective conditions, we speak of an extraverted attitude" (C. G. Jung - V6 - §563).

Extraverts have their attention directed to the external world and other people. They tend to be heavily influenced and shaped by their environment, culture, and the opinion of others. To the point that if they were to be born in a different culture their personalities would easily be molded by it. For that reason, they tend to be socially adapted and have a collective way of thinking and behaving. They see the world as something empty, so they "lend" their *souls* to animate external objects, they think and feel outside themselves – in the objects.

As they're constantly seeking to affect and being affected, they find themselves in the changeable and tend to be more flexible and malleable. For that same reason, they lack inner conviction and have difficulty perceiving their own individuality. To the point that they can completely lose their sense of self in the objects and their environment. Most of them have a deep fear of being alone, there's no solid core to sustain their position, as they can change their minds and emotional states at any given moment if they're affected by something external.

Introverts

"Although the introverted consciousness is naturally aware of external conditions, it selects the subjective determinants as the decisive ones" (C. G. Jung - V6 - §621).

Introverts have their attention directed to their inner world. Although they're obviously aware of external conditions, their environment, and their culture, their ego and subjective opinion have a higher value. They're constantly filtering the external reality interposed by their subjectivity, and they seek to shield themselves from the world and control it, instead of being absorbed by it like extraverts.

They seek to be constant, and that's why they tend to be more rigid and inflexible, and tend to guide themselves from a firm set of conscious or unconscious rules. This is an attempt to control the outcome and protect themselves from *affects* and the influence of other people and their environment. In extreme cases, there's a constant worry about the future and agoraphobia. As a result, they tend to be socially awkward and even find socializing draining. However, they tend to have a rich inner life, conviction, and a sense of uniqueness. However, they need to be cautious to not turn this into empty individualism, and ego-centrism, disregarding the outside world and constructing a shallow antagonistic character, because they secretly think they're better than everyone.

4.2 - The Four Functions

The second layer of the *psychological types* is the four functions:

"Consciousness is primarily an organ of orientation in a world of outer and inner facts. First and foremost, it establishes the fact that something is there. I call this faculty *sensation*. By this I do not mean the specific activity of any one of the senses, but perception in general. Another faculty interprets what is perceived; this I call *thinking*. By means of this function, the object perceived is assimilated and its transformation into a psychic content proceeds much further than in mere sensation. A third faculty establishes the value of the object. This function of evaluation I call *feeling*. The pain-pleasure reaction of feeling marks the highest degree of subjectivation of the object. Feeling brings subject and object into such a close relationship that the subject must choose between acceptance and rejection" (C. G. Jung - V8 - §256).

"These three functions would be quite sufficient for orientation if the object in question were isolated in space and time. But, in space, every object is in endless connection with a multiplicity of other objects; and, in time, the object represents merely a transition from a former state to a succeeding one. Most of the spatial relationships and temporal changes are unavoidably unconscious at the moment of orientation, and yet, in order to determine the meaning of an object, space-time relationships are necessary. It is the fourth faculty of consciousness, *intuition*, which makes possible, at least approximately, the determination of space-time relationships. This is a function of perception which includes subliminal factors, that is, the possible relationship to objects not appearing in the field of vision, and the possible changes, past and future, about which the

object gives no clue. Intuition is an immediate awareness of relationships that could not be established by the other three functions at the moment of orientation” (C. G. Jung - V8 - §257).

As we’ve seen, the four functions make two pairs of opposites, and in order for one of them to work properly the other has to be suppressed:

- *Thinking* and *feeling*.
- *Intuition* and *sensation*.

We tend to be guided by only one of these four functions, which is called the *main function*. Jung says that "When a function habitually predominates, a typical attitude is produced. According to the nature of the differentiated function, there will be constellations of contents that create a corresponding attitude. There is thus a typical thinking, feeling, sensation, and intuitive attitude” (C.G Jung - V6 - §691). In that way, we’ll have people guided by each one of these functions, *thinking types*, *feeling types*, *intuitive types*, and *sensation types*.

Now, let’s explore the four functions individually.

Thinking Function

Thinking is very logical, rational, and processual. It tells us *what a thing is* and adds concepts and ideas, through a process of comparison. It has the tendency to be very detached, neutral, and cold. It sees everything with equal value.

Feeling Function

Feeling is the function that tells us the worth and value of something and that’s why it’s contrary to *thinking*. It places judgments if you like or dislike something if it’s acceptable or not. It adds “color”, nuances, and adjectives to the objects. The *feeling* function is deeply personal and tends to create relationships with things. It gives you the ability to perceive the emotional

atmosphere and understand your own feelings and of others. It's the main function used in connecting with other people and relationships.

Here, we have to make an important distinction, the *feeling function* isn't the same as having emotions or *affects*. Jung says that "The differences would be this: *feeling* has no physical or tangible physiological manifestations, while emotion (*affects*) is characterized by an altered physiological condition" (C. G. Jung - V18.1 - §46). Therefore, when you experience a deep overwhelming emotion you're not "in" your feeling function, you're simply having an *affect*. The *feeling function* is the conscious experience of an emotion and it's subject to the conscious will.

Sensation Function

Sensation is the function of reality and provides the perception of the physical stimulus, both externally and internally. It's the awareness of everything we can perceive with the five senses. It's very detail oriented, grounded in reality, and in the present moment.

Intuition Function

Intuition is the closest function to the unconscious and that's why it has a metaphorical and symbolic language. It's contrary to *sensation* because it's future-oriented, it sees the potential of things and what they can become. The *Intuition function* sees things as a finished whole, instead of small details. It tends to present itself in images and metaphors to the conscious mind, or a certain hunch or gut feeling.

The Four Functions Applied

Now, let's apply everything we've learned so far in a simple example. Let's say you're talking with someone, a person with a *thinking* tendency will pay attention to the words, their logical sequence, and if things make sense from a rational standpoint. A person guided by their feelings will be able to perceive through the words and apprehend the emotional atmosphere and true intentions behind what's being said. Now, a person guided by *sensation* will pay attention to their subtle gestures, their clothes, tone of voice, and micro-expressions, and this will give them the

information they need. Lastly, a person guided by *intuition* might have a certain hunch or gut feeling about the person and immediately know if they can be good friends or not. They can also perceive specific images in their minds while they're interacting that contain crucial information.

The 8 Psychological Types

Finally, If we pair the extraverted and introverted tendencies with one of the four functions we get the *eight psychological types*. Each one of the types has its peculiarities and you can find more about them in the tenth chapter of *Psychological Types*:

- Extraverted or Introverted Thinking Type.
- Extraverted or Introverted Feeling Type.
- Extraverted or Introverted Sensation Type.
- Extraverted or Introverted Intuition Type.

4.3 - The Inferior Function

The *inferior function* "Is the ever-bleeding wound of the conscious personality, but through it the unconscious can always come in and so enlarge consciousness and bring forth new experience. As long as you have not developed your other functions, your auxiliary functions, they too will be open doors, so in a person who has only developed one superior function, the two auxiliary functions will operate in the same way and will appear in personifications of the *shadow*, *animus*, and *anima*. It is only when you have succeeded in developing three functions, in locking three of your inner doors, that the problem of the fourth door still remains, for that is the one which is apparently not meant to be locked. There one has to succumb, one has to suffer defeat, in order to develop further" (Marie Von Franz - Psychotherapy - p. 99).

The problem of the *inferior function* is incredibly complex and is one of the main secrets of the *individuation process*. Theoretically, Carl Jung established that the development of the personality revolves around the four functions. First, we should develop our *main function*, then we should develop one *auxiliary function*, as a third step, we should develop the opposite of the auxiliary function, and finally touch the *inferior function*. In my case, being an introverted intuitive type, I should develop my *intuition*, then *thinking* or *feeling* as an auxiliary one, in my case is *thinking*. As a third step I should develop *feeling*, and finally touch on my *inferior sensation*. I know this is wildly abstract but as a methodology it's incredibly helpful in the therapeutic setting.

Turning things a bit more practical, let's remember that everything that's incompatible with our *conscious attitude* will form our *shadow*, and when we're guided by one of the functions, the opposite one will invariably be repressed and remain unconscious, becoming our *inferior function*. So if you're guided by *thinking*, your *inferior function* will be *feeling*, and vice-versa, if you're guided by *intuition*, your *inferior function* will be *sensation*, and vice-versa. The same thing is valid for *introversion* and *extraversion*. In this light, one of the main components of our *shadow* is our *inferior function*, and its expression tends to be very slow and awkward, it appears and disappears at its own will, and frequently arises explosively and uncontrollably. In the book "Psychotherapy", Marie Von Franz also brings an extremely interesting point saying that the *inferior function* is usually projected on the body. Lastly, she summarizes everything with one simple question: "What is hell for you?" The answer might lead you straight to your *inferior function*.

But as with everything in Jungian Psychology, the *inferior function* has a paradoxical nature, because it contains the inner gold and the seeds to enlarge our personality. It's when we're engaging with the *inferior function* that we find the most joy and sense of wholeness. It's the source of our creativity and inspiration and it contains the exact parts we need to access in order to solve our inner and outer conflicts and further our individuation journey. Lastly, Jung says that the technical term for the *animus* and *anima* is the *inferior function*, however, we tend to find them personified, making the *animus* and *anima* the empirical observation of the *inferior function*. Lastly, I'll give you a brief overview of the *inferior function* of each one of the types.

Thinking Type with Inferior Feeling

A *thinking type* will have an *inferior feeling* and tend to have a very childish relationship with their emotions, especially in relationships. Their judgments are usually black and white, and they can become touchy-feely, moody, or extremely harsh and cold.

Feeling Type With Inferior Thinking

A *feeling type* will have *inferior thinking* and will tend to have a hard time seeing things from a detached perspective and making judgments from a logical and detached standpoint. There's a tendency of having very negative, tyrannical, obsessive, and compulsive thoughts, about themselves and others. They can even have a hard time learning things like philosophy and everything that's more conceptual and theoretically abstract. Conceiving a *cosmovision* also tends to be very difficult.

Sensation Type With Inferior Intuition

A *sensation type* will have *inferior intuition* and will have the tendency to fear everything that's more abstract, their inner fantasies, and deeply fear the future. They can't see past what's in front of them and considering potentials is very hard. They can even develop very morbid and weird fantasies, as well as obsessive behaviors.

Intuitive Type With Inferior Sensation

An *intuitive type* will have *inferior sensation* and will have the tendency to live in fantasy land and be detached from reality. They can be wrapped in future possibilities and never materialize anything in the now. They have difficulty connecting with their own bodies, their five senses, and paying attention to details, which can also lead to addictions, phobias, and hypochondria, as a compensation.

In conclusion, we'll have a *main function* which is the main guide of our *conscious attitude* and we can also develop an *auxiliary function*, both will be introverted or extroverted, according to our tendencies. For instance, I'm an introvert with *intuition* as a *main function* and *thinking* as an *auxiliary function*. Therefore *extraverted sensation* is my *inferior function* and *extraverted feeling* is also felt as a weak spot.

Distorted Types

If you can't relate to any of this, perhaps you're just not aware of your own tendencies or you're a *distorted type*. This is very common and happens when someone couldn't develop their *main function* properly. For instance, picture a *feeling/ intuitive type* with a strong creative and artistic personality, but he was raised by a family of engineers and dry intellectuals that suppressed any display of emotion, affection, spontaneity, or creativity. As a result this person never developed their main capacity and had to try to adapt to a function that's their weak spot. This will generate all sorts of issues and the solution lies in going back and developing your original *main function*.

5. The Animus and Anima - The *Hierosgamos*

5.1 - Archetypes

Before we discuss the *animus* and *anima*, it's imperative to have clarity about the concept of *archetypes*. It took me about two years of reading Jung daily and a decent experience with active imagination to fully grasp this idea. But what actually inspired me to write this section was witnessing Argentina winning the World Cup. As a Brazilian living in Buenos Aires, this experience was utterly astonishing. I'll begin by introducing the concepts and tying up everything in the end.

Let's begin with a footnote from *Archetypes and The Collective Unconscious*, "To the best of my knowledge, no other suggestions have been made so far. Critics have contented themselves with asserting that no such archetypes exist. Certainly they do not exist, any more than a botanical system exists in nature! But will anyone deny the existence of natural plant-families on that account? Or will anyone deny the occurrence and continual repetition of certain morphological and functional similarities? It is much the same thing in principle with the typical figures of the unconscious. They are forms existing *a priori*, or biological norms of psychic activity" (C. G. Jung - V9.1 – p. 646).

The first thing we have to realize is that *archetypes* don't physically exist, they're actually an organizing principle and exist as a potential to experience something psychologically and physiologically in a similar and definite way. In that sense, *archetypes* are like a blueprint, a structure, or a pattern and all four functions are required to apprehend it. *Archetypes* will evoke a typical thought pattern, a definite set of emotions, typical physical sensations, and definite fantasies.

Archetypes – The Image of Instincts

Archetypes will also elicit patterns of behavior and this happens because they form an axis with instincts, where the former is an imagetic representation of the instinctual pattern. Jung places both on a spectrum, where instincts are represented by the infra-red part and *archetypes* by the ultraviolet part. Using a nerdy analogy, instincts are the hardware of a computer and *archetypes* the software, and together they form the "Human Operational System".

Being influenced by Kant, Jung disregards the notion that humans are a "*tabula rasa* to be marked by experience", and establishes that *archetypes* are forms existing *a priori* (or beforehand) exactly because they aren't learned but inherited. *Archetypes* act as a filter to our human experience, therefore, humans have similar patterns of behavior, a similar thought structure, a similar way of experiencing emotions, physical sensations, and symbolic representations.

A bit of theoretical foundation:

“There are, in fact, no amorphous instincts, as every instinct bears in itself the pattern of its situation. Always it fulfills an image, and the image has fixed qualities. The instinct of the leaf-cutting ant fulfills the image of ant, tree, leaf, cutting, transport, and the little ant-garden of fungi. If any one of these conditions is lacking, the instinct does not function, because it cannot exist without its total pattern, without its image. Such an image is an *a priori* type. It is inborn in the ant prior to any activity, for there can be no activity at all unless an instinct of corresponding pattern initiates and makes it possible. This schema holds true of all instincts and is found in identical form in all individuals of the same species. The same is true also of man: he has in him these *a priori* instinct-types which provide the occasion and the pattern for his activities, in so far as he functions instinctively. As a biological being he has no choice but to act in a specifically human way and fulfill his pattern of behaviour. This sets narrow limits to his possible range of volition, the more narrow the more primitive he is, and the more his consciousness is dependent upon the instinctual sphere. [...] We may say that the image represents the *meaning* of the instinct” (C. G. Jung - V8 – §398).

- **Instincts:** “Instincts are typical modes of action, and wherever we meet with uniform and regularly recurring modes of action and reaction we are dealing with instinct, no matter whether it is associated with a conscious motive or not” (C. G. Jung - V8 – §273).

Examples: Hunger, sexuality, reflection, and creativity.

- **Archetypes:** “Archetypes are typical modes of apprehension, and wherever we meet with uniform and regularly recurring modes of apprehension we are dealing with an archetype, no matter whether its mythological character is recognized or not” (C. G. Jung - V8 – §280).

Archetypes x Archetypal Images

Here's where the confusion usually starts and opens precedents for the wildest things. Remember that *archetypes* don't exist, their true nature is actually irrepresentable, that's why Jung refers to them as *psychoid*. What our conscious mind can perceive is a set of ideas and images that allude to this organizing principle. A great example is the Tarot cards, they aren't *archetypes*, but their symbols can allude to one. Furthermore, *archetypes* lie in the unconscious realm, which means that they're not accessible to our conscious mind and aren't subject to our will, we can simply perceive them. So things like learning to "activate archetypes" or "using their energy" are simply a scam. Also, there aren't a definite number of *archetypes*, they are as infinite as human experience can be. So don't fall prey to things like the 12 archetypes (or any number really).

A note on its *psychoid* nature:

"The archetype as such is a psychoid factor that belongs, as it were, to the invisible, ultraviolet end of the psychic spectrum. It does not appear, in itself, to be capable of reaching consciousness. [...] Since other archetypes give rise to similar doubts, it seems to me probable that the real nature of the archetype is not capable of being made conscious, that it is transcendent, on which account I call it psychoid. Moreover every archetype, when represented to the mind, is already conscious and therefore differs to an indeterminable extent from that which caused the representation. [...] We must, however, constantly bear in mind that what we mean by "archetype" is in itself irrepresentable, but has effects which make visualizations of it possible, namely, the archetypal images and ideas" (C. G. Jung - V8 – §417).

"Archetypes are typical forms of behaviour which, once they become conscious, naturally present themselves *as ideas and images*, like everything else that becomes a content of consciousness" (C. G. Jung - V8 – §435).

Archetypes and Religious Experiences

Archetypes are also responsible for religious experiences, which means they have a *numinous* (compulsive) quality and force themselves upon consciousness when constellated. To

Jung, “Religion, as the Latin word denotes, is a careful and scrupulous observation of what Rudolf Otto aptly termed the *numinosum*, that is, a dynamic agency or effect not caused by an arbitrary act of will. On the contrary, it seizes and controls the human subject, who is always rather its victim than its creator. The *numinosum* —whatever its cause may be—is an experience of the subject independent of his will. At all events, religious teaching as well as the *consensus gentium* always and everywhere explain this experience as being due to a cause external to the individual. The *numinosum* is either a quality belonging to a visible object or the influence of an invisible presence that causes a peculiar alteration of consciousness. This is, at any rate, the general rule” (C. G. Jung - V11 – §6).

Whenever we’re experiencing an archetypal situation, a definite set of thoughts, emotions, sensations, and fantasies will arise, all with a compulsive quality, evoking the feeling that we’re hostages to this overwhelming experience. For instance, the rapturous feeling we have when we fall in love and all the ideas and ludicrous displays that come with it. All the arduous challenges we face in the transition from childhood to adulthood, how the first sexual experience changes someone forever, or even the experience of parenthood or the death of a beloved one. All of these experiences are typically human, and we get to live and share them in a collective way.

Lastly, an archetypal situation is also a living thing that places us inside a drama, with certain characters, obstacles, conflicts, and decisions. An *archetype* is attached to a definite narrative and evokes a storyline, with a beginning, its *peripeteia*, and a culmination. Like the great temptation Jesus had to endure for forty days in the desert. Or when we feel completely raptured by a *femme fatale* or Don Juan figure, or even when we feel completely torn in the face of a tough decision.

A few examples of archetypes:

- The Idea of God or “the first cause” shaped many schools of thought and all religions.
- The Mother, Father, Child, Shaman, Wise old Man and Woman.

- Mythological Motifs: The hero's journey, the magical escape, descending to hell (*Katabasis*), helping animals, metamorphosis, the treasure hardly attained, the cave and the dragon, the guardian of the threshold, *psychopomps*, *animus* and *anima*, femme fatale and Don Juan.

Lionel Messi As The Messiah

Being born in the country of football you must think that I've witnessed everything there's to see about it. Well, I thought that too. Until the World Cup started and I constantly heard Lionel Messi being referred to as "Messi – The Messiah". It's important to remember that an *archetype* is completely amorphous and only takes a definite form and fixed qualities when it's projected. What's interesting is that for something to be projected, the receiver has to bear at least a resemblance to that image. For instance, you can't project an inner tyrant if the person in question isn't minimally sure of himself and possesses a minimum degree of authority, projection needs a "hook".

Now, the Christ or savior archetype can also overlap with the Divine Child or the Child of Promise, and they always have to fight against evil or something destructive as soon as they're born, plus they're always rescued by a miracle. This happened with Jesus of Nazareth and also a few fictional characters like Naruto and Harry Potter. If you research a bit, you'll learn that at the age of 11 Lionel Messi was diagnosed with a rare disease, called Growth Hormone Disorder. This condition doesn't allow the body to grow as it should according to age. At the age of 12, Messi had to inject growth hormones into his leg every night.

However, the cost of the treatment was too high, and his family was struggling to continue to afford the hormone injections. At this time, FC Barcelona came to Messi's rescue and the 13-year-old boy was offered a spot in their team and sponsored his medical expenses. You might think that this is completely random, and there's a great chance that you're right, but I find it fascinating how things have developed. You must also know that Argentina once was one of the richest countries on earth but now they're experiencing their darkest economic times. I'm witnessing protests every single week and the country is extremely polarized, what an auspicious moment for a savior to come. Also, It's astonishing how football occupied the place of religion in Argentina and the power it acquired to unite people.

Thereby, the savior is the one who can unify the opposites, bring peace, and end every battle. It's the one that can set us free and allow us to be happy, to celebrate, to be in communion with our neighbors, he can give us that sublime feeling that lifts our spirit. Here it comes Messi – The Messiah, a brilliant player who can grant us this grace. At this moment, Argentinians are collectively projecting the savior image upon Messi, which prompts them to have their religious experience. In the exact same way people feel saved by Christ (or any other religious personality), they felt saved by Messi. In every single game, there were people in the streets celebrating as if they had won the World Cup until they reached the finals, and their dream finally came true. Chills! Witnessing all of this happening at a five-minute walk from the city center – “The Obelisco” – was one of the craziest experiences of my life, and I'm extremely lucky to be a part of it.

5.2 - The Eros and Logos

Now that we've covered *archetypes*, we can finally explore the *animus* and *anima*. For this specific section, I'd like to express my gratitude to my teacher Fernando Rodrigues who unlocked my understanding of the Eros and Logos, this allowed me to organize and add my own experience. The first thing we have to get out of the way is that when we're discussing these concepts we're not discussing gender. We can't equate *anima* with women and *animus* with men. We have to remember that Jung wasn't an essentialist, he had an empirical approach. This means that he didn't “create” these concepts out of nowhere, rather he found these archetypal images following the comparative method after studying a plethora of myths, religions, cultures, and dreams. He never stated how a man or woman should act, this would be just ridiculous. *Archetypes* transcend the personal and individual level, and of course gender.

Before we discuss the *animus* and *anima* we have to explore the concepts of Eros and Logos, because they're the generating archetypal principles of the *animus* and *anima*. Jung “Regarded both concepts as intuitive ideas which cannot be defined accurately or exhaustively. From the scientific point of view this is regrettable, but from a practical one it has its value, since the two concepts mark out a field of experience which it is equally difficult to define” (C. G. Jung - V14 – §223).

These concepts cannot be grasped solely on an intellectual level, about half of the experience with the unconscious can be translated into words and theory, and the other half has to

be lived and embodied. That's why knowledge of myths and symbols, and real experience are essential to grasp its meaning. I'll do my best to explain these ideas and point you in the right direction so you can organize your own experience.

The Eros and Logos:

“A descendent of Logos is Nous, the intellect, which has done away with the commingling of feeling, presentiment, and sensation. In contrast, the Logos contains this commingling. But it is not the product of such blending, or else it would be a lower animalistic psychic activity; yet it masters the blend, so that the four fundamental activities of the soul become subordinate to its principle. It is an independent principle of form that means understanding, insight, foresight, legislation, and wisdom. The figure of an old prophet is therefore a fitting allegory for this principle, since the prophetic spirit unites in itself all these qualities. In contrast, Eros is a principle that contains a commingling of all the fundamental activities of the soul just as much as it masters them, although its purpose is completely different. It is not form-giving but form-fulfilling; it is the wine that will be poured into the vessel; it is not the bed and direction of the stream but the impetuous water flowing in it. Eros is desire, longing, force, exuberance, pleasure, suffering. Where Logos is ordering and insistence, Eros is dissolution and movement. They are two fundamental psychic powers that form a pair of opposites, each one requiring the other” (C. G. Jung - The Red Book, p. 365).

To make things easier, Carl Jung immediately relates these archetypal principles with the Yin and Yang – where the extremes touch and convert into one another. They are the supreme pair of opposites that give the *psyche* its dynamism. Here I've made a chart with all the qualities I could find so you can better visualize it:

Eros:

- Yin – The dark, cold, and moist.
- The capacity to relate – Ambiguity.
- Personal.
- Lunar character – Irrationality – Chthonic – Nature.
- Openness – Receptiveness – Emptiness – Cyclical.
- Desire, longing, force, exuberance, pleasure, suffering, dissolution, and movement.

Logos:

- Yang – The light, warm, and dry.
- Discrimination – Judgment – Insight.
- Impersonal – Detached – Equal Dignity.
- Solar character – Rationality – Spiritual.
- The principle of will and action – Linear.
- Ordering, insistence, understanding, insight, foresight, legislation, and wisdom.

Although both principles need the four functions to be fully grasped as well as a union of conscious and unconscious qualities, for didactic purposes we can say that the Eros principle is more closely related to the irrational functions, namely *sensation*, and *intuition*. While the Logos is more closely related to the rational functions, namely *thinking* and *feeling*. One common mistake is to equate Logos with the *thinking function* and intellect, but to Jung, the *feeling function* is also rational, as it operates with categories and a clear scale of values used to make judgments, otherwise, we only have dry and unfruitful rationalism.

As for the Eros, we have to remember that irrational is extra rational, in other words, it has a way of functioning distinct from conscious experience and obeys its own laws. While *thinking* and *feeling* have clear categories of good and evil, in the unconscious the lines are blurred. A physical sensation and the symbolic images that arise from the unconscious don't have any judgment attached to them, they're pure experience, what places clear judgments is always the conscious mind.

That's why Jung equates Logos with the Sun, as under this glaring light we can clearly see things separated from one another, and it's possible to categorize, judge, and discriminate. It sees everything with equal dignity and from a position of detachment. That's also why the Logos is more closely related to the mechanism of introversion, as it creates impersonal abstractions and creates separations. As Jung says, Logos is what allows a scientist to have a "Religious concentration to the classification of lice, or to the different qualities of feces, to put it quite drastically as well as to counting the stars" (Barbara Hannah - The Animus, p. 124).

Now, we can equate the Eros principle with the moon, as under its mild light everything dissolves and starts to blend with one another, the lines are blurred, and instead of division, we start to see how things are related. That's why the Eros is more closely related to the mechanism of extroversion, since it seeks to be merged with the objects. With Eros, everything is ambiguous and challenges our perception of good and evil. That's why dealing with the figures from the unconscious is so difficult, as they obey the laws of nature. They're always paradoxical and contact with them can either give or take life.

The Eros has a very personal quality and it's about relatedness and reunion. It has an earthy and chthonic quality, it connects us with the five senses and the body, while the Logos is more

abstract and about the spiritual realm. The Logos is about knowledge, while the Eros is about relationships. The Logos is the principle of will and action, it wants to maintain and conserve things. While the Eros is about openness, receptivity, and emptiness. The Eros desires and longs, it's dynamic and about movement, and that's why it's also the principle of dissolution and transformation. The Logos gives form and shapes, it's the vessel which is filled by the Eros. The Logos is the demarcation of a river, while the Eros is the very flow of water.

Lastly, the Eros is the principle of individuation because it's about desire, and we only desire because something is absent, we don't have it. So the Eros makes us long for what we can become, for our individuation, as the Eros can turn two opposing truths into one. Suffering is what we pay for this transformation because we have to sacrifice our current personality, our illusions, and the stories we've been telling ourselves for the sake of a new personality. Enduring the paradox is always a very laborious and lengthy process. Finally, the Eros is what bounds us to situations in which we have to face the reality of ourselves, usually, they are very painful, but from these experiences and many times mistakes, the possibility of a new conscience arises. The Eros connects us with something deeper within ourselves, it links us with the experience of god. That's why an unconscious Eros is equated with the will to power which is contrary to love and promotes separation and destroys the connection with our soul and relationships.

The Animus and Anima

I started by saying that we can't equate the *animus* and Logos with men and the Eros and *anima* with women because these are psychological and archetypal principles that go beyond gender. These are forces that have been present since the beginning of mankind and their functioning can be found across all cultures in the *syzygies*. That said, we have to remember that the unconscious is the receptacle of all human experience, both biological and cultural. During the history of mankind, the Logos was projected upon men and the Eros upon women. This means that the conscious mind of men is identified with the Logos and the Eros is unconscious, as for women, their conscious mind is identified with Eros and the Logos is unconscious.

As Barbara Hannah says, "It is just as possible to live one's life by signposts that exist in relationships as it is to live by the signposts in discriminating knowledge" (Barbara Hannah – The Animus, p. 122). We also have to remember that the nature of the unconscious is to be personified,

so in the unconscious of men we tend to find the image of a woman that symbolizes the Eros principle, and in the unconscious of women, we tend to find the image of a man that symbolizes the Logos principle.

Why is that? ... Well, that's a metaphysical question that's impossible to have a definite answer. There's an amalgamation of psychological predispositions, biology, and culture. How much each of these components contributed to it it's impossible to determine. Perhaps there's an alternative reality where things are switched, but in ours, that's how things have been operating. Furthermore, never forget that the Eros and Logos are not equated with gender, that said, in theory, it's possible to have a man with a conscious Eros and a woman with a conscious Logos. Personally, I've never seen it. I had the pleasure of working with both homosexual and bisexual men and women, and their *psyches* always revealed the same *psychodynamics* and archetypal images.

Again, we're not discussing gender, so the *anima* can be projected upon men and the *animus* can be projected upon women. In fact, both the *animus* and *anima* are responsible for most of our projections regardless of gender and this happens all of the time. If you're unsure, the easiest way to find out is to observe your own dreams and learn how the *animus* and *anima* operate. In my personal experience, sexual preferences don't change that. However, we always have to see how this is operating on an individual level, so this remains an open question and I don't claim to have the truth, I can only share my experience.

The Animus and Anima Personified

This identification with Logos or Eros will generate a counterpart in the unconscious, and we'll be able to find it personified, that's why the *animus* and *anima* function like *complexes*, or as "*autonomous personalities*".

"I have often been accused of personifying the anima and animus as mythology does, but this accusation would be justified only if it could be proved that I concretize these concepts in a mythological manner for psychological use. I must declare once and for all that the personification is not an invention of mine, but is inherent in the nature of the phenomena. It would be unscientific to overlook the fact that the anima is a psychic, and therefore a personal, autonomous system. None

of the people who make the charge against me would hesitate for a second to say, “I dreamed of Mr. X,” whereas, strictly speaking, he dreamed only of a representation of Mr. X. The anima is nothing but a representation of the personal nature of the autonomous system in question. What the nature of this system is in a transcendental sense, that is, beyond the bounds of experience, we cannot know” (C. G. Jung - V13 – §61).

Always take into account the notion of *psychic reality*, for it’s the only way of truly experiencing the unconscious and correctly organizing this experience without falling prey to metaphysics. These figures stem from the collective unconscious, so only a portion of it can become conscious and integrated, what’s possible is to have a dialogue with them and maintain an open *conscious attitude* that allows them to function properly, because they will always behave like an *autonomous complex*. Now, it’s a good time to remember that the conscious and unconscious have a *compensatory/ complementary* relationship, and the unconscious will always react to the *conscious attitude*. Furthermore, the *animus* and *anima* constitute a pair of opposites with the *persona*. So just as the *persona* is the function of relationship with the external world, the *animus* and *anima* will be the function of relationship with the inner world.

The Persona Compensation

“The persona is a complicated system of relations between the individual consciousness and society, fittingly enough a kind of mask, designed on the one hand to make a definite impression upon others, and, on the other, to conceal the true nature of the individual. That the latter function is superfluous could be maintained only by one who is so identified with his persona that he no longer knows himself; and that the former is unnecessary could only occur to one who is quite unconscious of the true nature of his fellows” (C. G. Jung - V7 – §305).

The *persona* always invites us to maintain an image of perfection, to play our social role, and to do exactly what is demanded and expected of us. In this process, we lose our sense of individuality and give in to external pressure. We become our titles, and our careers, and identify with labels, gender roles, and conventions. In this process, we lose touch with the inner reality, and the more we identify with the *persona*, the less conscious we are about the depths of our being. This creates a split, and the *animus* and *anima* rebel against us and start to pull the strings in a negative way because these are essential qualities of our personality that aren’t being expressed.

Of course, the *persona* is not wholly bad, it allows us to navigate the external world and live in society. The problem starts when you're just your *persona*, everyone knows that guy who is extremely likable and friendly with everyone, and no one imagines that he could hurt a fly. But suddenly, we discover that he's terrible with his wife and kids. This tends to happen a lot with public figures and with people who have a very social role and preach high moral standards. The more perfect you try to be, the more you invite an unconscious reaction. As Jung says, this *persona* identification always leads to a *neurosis* and this artificial personality is punished by bad moods, *affects*, phobias, obsessive ideas, backslidings, vices, timidity, and even a limp sexuality (culminating in impotence).

This happens especially with men who give in to the macho stereotype, "The persona, the ideal picture of a man as he should be, is inwardly compensated by feminine weakness, and as the individual outwardly plays the strong man, so he becomes inwardly a woman, i.e., the anima, for it is the anima that reacts to the persona. But because the inner world is dark and invisible to the extraverted consciousness, and because a man is all the less capable of conceiving his weaknesses the more he is identified with the persona, the persona's counterpart, the anima, remains completely in the dark and is at once projected, so that our hero comes under the heel of his wife's slipper. If this results in a considerable increase of her power, she will acquit herself none too well. She becomes inferior, thus providing her husband with the welcome proof that it is not he, the hero, who is inferior in private, but his wife. In return the wife can cherish the illusion, so attractive to many, that at least she has married a hero, unperturbed by her own uselessness. This little game of illusion is often taken to be the whole meaning of life" (C. G. Jung - V7 – §309).

I'm talking mainly about men here, but in reality both the *animus* and *anima* are especially poisonous when you try to hold an ideal of perfection, when you try to have a supreme morality, and when you give in to stereotypes. In that sense, cultural ideals of what a man or woman should be are always detrimental to our psychological development. These inner figures always invite us to discover our individuality and develop our unique way of being.

The Animus and Anima as Complexes

Jung “Understands these figures to be function complexes behaving in ways compensatory to the outer personality, that is, behaving as if they were inner personalities and exhibiting the characteristics which are lacking in the outer, and manifest, conscious personality. In a man, these are feminine characteristics, in a woman, masculine. Normally both are always present, to a certain degree, but find no place in the person’s outwardly directed functioning because they disturb his outer adaptation, his established ideal image of himself” (Emma Jung – The Animus and Anima, p. 3).

Again, the *animus* and *anima* are the ultimate compensation for our *conscious attitude* and they have all the qualities that can complement our personality and make us whole. However, this process obviously is not easy, as the interaction with these figures always threatens to destroy our *conscious attitude*, as they hold such opposing values. We need to cultivate a strong and flexible ego to hold this paradox so as to produce a new synthesis of our personality and advance in our individuation journey. In that way, both the *animus* and *anima* become *psychopomps*, which means that they act as bridges between personal and impersonal, and between conscious and unconscious. In other words, they stop interfering with our daily lives and relationships and help us reach a fine balance between conscious and unconscious, by bringing to our conscious mind the contents that can balance our personality.

Emma Jung says that there’s three main things that condition the animus and anima:

“However, the character of these figures is not determined only by the latent sexual characteristics they represent; it is conditioned by the experience each person has had in the course of his or her life with representatives of the other sex, and also by the collective image of woman carried in the psyche of the individual man, and the collective image of man carried by the woman. These three factors coalesce to form a quantity which is neither solely an image nor solely experience, but an entity not organically coordinated in its activity with the other psychic functions. It behaves as if it were a law unto itself, interfering in the life of the individual as if it were an alien element; sometimes the interference is helpful, sometimes disturbing, if not actually destructive. We have, therefore, every cause to concern ourselves with these psychic entities and arrive at an understanding of how they influence us” (Emma Jung - The Animus and Anima, p. 3).

Remember that the *psyche* is historic, it doesn't exist in a vacuum, so there's a mixture of biological tendencies, archetypal predispositions, as well as individual experiences that configure the *animus* and *anima*. Also, the *parental complexes* play a great role. In men, the *father complex* serves as a basis for the *persona* and the *mother complex* as a basis for the *anima*. While in women, the *mother complex* serves as a basis for the *persona* and the *father complex* as a basis for the *animus*. Consequently, what happens is that we absorb certain patterns from the relationship with the parents and they become like a blueprint about how to behave in the world and how to relate with the *animus* and *anima*. That's why it's so important to understand the *mother* and *father complex* before the *animus* and *anima*, luckily we already covered that in the second chapter.

The Animus and Anima Function

“If I were to attempt to put in a nutshell the difference between man and woman in this respect, i.e., what it is that characterizes the animus as opposed to the anima, I could only say this: as the anima produces *moods*, so the animus produces *opinions*; and as the moods of a man issue from a shadowy background, so the opinions of a woman rest on equally unconscious prior assumptions”. (C. G. Jung - V7 – 331).

In a woman, the Logos will have the function of providing true insight, which aids the woman in crafting their own particulate worldview instead of operating with prejudices and prior assumptions that tend to destroy their relationships. It gives the woman a connection with the spiritual realm, inspiration, and drive to go after what she wants. While in the man, the *anima* has mainly the function to give him consciousness of his own emotional life, value system, insight about his relationships, and true purpose in life. Both these figures are also related to creativity and everything that can embellish life and our relationships.

An interesting observation here is that in ancient times the *anima* and *animus* were projected upon the gods, they had their place in people's lives. Nowadays, most people don't have a connection with their inner world and cultivate their spirituality, this exacerbates how much the *animus* and *anima* are projected in relationships, and this creates compulsions and toxicity because you expect the other person to give you your own sense of purpose, meaning, and spiritual connection. You expect the other person to be a divine entity and when they don't correspond,

because no human being can, chaos ensues. The *animus* and *anima* invite us to understand and connect with our *souls* and cultivate our unique sense of spirituality.

Lastly, Jung says that the technical term for the *animus* and *anima* is the *inferior function*, however, we tend to find them personified, making the *animus* and *anima* the empirical observation of the *inferior function*. That's why it's also important to make a link with typology as the *animus* and *anima* will acquire the opposite qualities of our *main function*. If you're a *thinking type* it will acquire the qualities of *feeling*, and vice versa. If you're an *intuitive type*, it will acquire the qualities of *sensation*, and vice versa. The same thing goes for introversion and extraversion.

5.3 - The Animus - The Archetype of Meaning

Now we're gonna explore the function of the *animus*, the main basis for this discussion is the book "The Animus - The Spirit of Inner Truth in Women" by Barbara Hannah and the book "The Animus and Anima" by Emma Jung. Let's remember that there's a tendency in women to be consciously identified with the Eros principle, therefore they will have an unconscious Logos. As Jung says, the conscious mind of a woman has a lunar character, that's why it's a common error to equate the moon with the unconscious, this can only be true for men. In a woman, the qualities of the Sun are unconscious. This lunar consciousness "Merges things together rather than separates them. It does not show up objects in all their pitiless discreteness and separateness, like the harsh, glaring light of the day" (C. G. Jung - V14 - §223).

Emma Jung complements by saying that this lack of discrimination makes women more open to the unconscious and they often discover and appraise spiritual values more quickly than men. During the time I worked as a meditation teacher, I could verify that, these places tend to be full of women trying to connect with their spiritual sides and men often dismiss these pursuits as something "irrational" that doesn't make any sense, in general, men tend to have a prejudice against Erotic values.

"If we ask ourselves why second sight and the art of prophecy are ascribed to woman, the answer is that in general she is more open to the unconscious than man. Receptivity is a feminine attitude, presupposing openness and emptiness, wherefore Jung has termed it the great secret of femininity. Moreover, the feminine mentality is less averse to irrationality than the rationally oriented

masculine consciousness, which tends to reject everything not conforming to reason and so frequently shuts itself off from the unconscious. In the *Phaedrus* Plato criticizes this over-reasonable attitude - especially in the matter of love - and praises the irrational, even the insane, insofar as it may be a divine gift” (Emma Jung - The Animus and Anima, p. 52).

The Animus

This Eros identification will generate an unconscious Logos and we know that the nature of the unconscious is to be personified, so the masculine image we find is denominated *animus* and it will behave like a *complex* with its own “personality”.

"By the *term animus* I understand the masculine spirit or *unconscious* mind of woman. Emma Jung pointed out recently that one should differentiate very carefully here between the anima and the animus. The anima, as is well known, is Jung's term for the *feminine soul* of man. But it is really a contradiction in terms to speak of the animus as the masculine soul in woman. (This error was made in the early days of Jungian psychology and is still often done today.) In latin the word *animus* means intellect, memory, consciousness, character, and spirit. It is often equated with “mind” and is also used to mean courage, vivacity, bravery, and will. In Jungian psychology it is used primarily to denote the phenomenon of “spirit” in women, and the contrast between the feminine soul (anima) and the masculine spirit (animus) gives us a valuable hint as to the difference between these two figures” (Barbara Hannah - The Animus, p. 2).

The *animus* contains all the qualities that can balance the conscious Eros, however, if the *animus* remains unconscious, it acquires this dark, tyrannical, and possessive quality, it escapes the conscious will and also suffocates the Eros principle. Here, we have to state the obvious and say that we live in a society dominated by the Logos principle and culturally we tend to devalue everything that has to do with Eros. Naturally, many women fall prey to these social values and devalue everything that has to do with the feminine. This generates a tendency to feel inferior and women forsake their own natures and seek to identify with more traditionally masculine values, and this obviously gives immense power to a negative *animus*.

That's why dealing with the *animus* requires that we start valuing everything that has to do with the feminine and Eros again. Women have to feel proud of who they are and don't conform to social norms that suffocate their personalities. It's only when we make the effort to make these figures conscious that they start to cooperate and open the possibility for individuation and unravel our inner gold, as these figures are always paradoxical, the relationship with them can either take or give life. In general, we can say that the Eros is always more interested in personal relationships than objective and impersonal facts. It gives the woman immense sensibility as she can perceive nuances in relationships that frequently escape a man entirely. Naturally, everything that has to do with Logos will be a blind spot. In that sense, the *animus* works mainly as an *opinionating substitute*:

"In general the animus personifies the spirit in woman while the anima represents the soul in man. In general we can say that, at the more rudimentary levels, the animus in the woman is the producer of opinions whereas the anima in man produces moods. But actually the part of the animus to which we can react and with which we can make contact is the merest fraction of the entity of spirit in the woman. In real life, women generally deal not with the entire animus but with that part of the animus which is mostly an *opinionating substitute* for the depths of the spirit. This would be the spirit of rationalization which indefatigably occupies itself with making these opinions seem logical, at least as seen from the point of view of the woman or of the collective society" (Barbara Hannah - The Animus, p. 2).

What happens is that the *animus* infiltrates a woman's train of thought and falsifies her reality with opinions that tend to be extremely critical, demeaning, and one-sided, and they appear to be the absolute truth. It's something the woman just assumes is the right thing, when in reality, she never really thought about it, it's something ready-made. Barbara Hannah says that Jung has often pointed out that when the *animus* interferes in a woman's daily life, it's usually in a place where she hasn't given the matter her fullest conscious consideration and particularly where she fails in the realm of *feeling*.

A very simple example that I hear all the time revolves around perfectionism. With phrases like, "If don't do it with absolute perfection it's not even worth trying". Or "If I'm going to clean the house I have to spend six hours scrubbing every inch of it or it doesn't count". Or even, "If I don't get straight 10's I'm an absolute failure". When you can't find a middle term, you can be sure

that the *animus* is operating. Also, the *animus* works with very impersonal and collective opinions about how people should be and act and how a relationship should work. It's like a formula that if it isn't followed everything is wrong. When you ask where did this come from, they love to say "People have always done it like this," or "Everybody says it is like that". When the *animus* is operating the woman loses that personal relatedness, because these opinions get in the way of her connection with the truth and individuality of the other person, and seeing the objective reality.

We can see this operating with comments like "Every man is like this" or "Every man treats women in such and such way". Or comments like why they can't have any female friends because "Every female is judgmental and they're never truthful". Or rules about how the perfect mother should be, or how a wife should behave. You can see that these are very impersonal opinions, and these rules prevent women from connecting with others on an individual level. Because if every man is in a determined way how is she going to know him as an individual? ... Everything he does will be filtered through these assumptions.

The Eros isn't limited to relationships, so everything that has to do with the body, the five senses, and pleasure will also suffer. With thoughts like how you can't have any fun and relax because you always have to be productive. If you're going traveling, for instance, everything has to be done in an exact order, leaving no room for spontaneity, there are always rules for fun. Another pattern is thoughts about how being in touch with their own bodies is a sin and disgusting.

Lastly, many women have to deal with demeaning thoughts about their appearance, their capabilities, or about what they truly want. Also, thoughts revolving around how they can't find any good quality in them, that they aren't unique and that's why they can't create anything. Or even thoughts about what they truly want in life is wrong and you have to conform to this other person's opinion or to society. The crazy thing is that none of this is the truth, it's just something that was unconsciously absorbed, and the *animus* will always seek these blind spots. That's why the main work of a woman is to challenge these thoughts, understand that they don't make any sense, and come up with her own values and beliefs. The relationship with the Eros principle has to be personal and individual, what matters to the woman has to be the most important thing, instead of giving in to collective rules and assumptions.

The Animus Problem

However, if the problem of the *animus* is not faced:

"If the problem is not faced, if woman does not meet adequately the demand for consciousness or intellectual activity, the animus becomes autonomous and negative, and works destructively on the individual herself and in her relations to other people. This fact can be explained as follows: if the possibility of spiritual functioning is not taken up by the conscious mind, the psychic energy intended for it falls into the unconscious, and there activates the archetype of the animus. Possessed of the energy that has flowed back into the unconscious, the animus figure becomes autonomous, so powerful, indeed, that it can overwhelm the conscious ego, and thus finally dominate the whole personality" (Emma Jung - The Animus and Anima, p. 7).

This is a principle in Jungian Psychology, every time that we don't consciously exert some faculty, it becomes unconscious and instead of functioning properly, it becomes destructive. Emma Jung says that when there's an identification with the *animus*, the women either didn't pay attention to her spiritual side or developed it in the wrong way. She points out that many women have this over-identification with their masculine side and externally it might seem that they have a positive *animus*, however, this always comes to the detriment of feminine values, and especially their relationships.

"To busy ourselves simply in an intellectual or objectively masculine way seems insufficient, as can be seen in many women who have completed a course of study and practice a heretofore masculine, intellectual calling, but who, nonetheless, have never come to terms with the animus problem. Such a masculine training and way of life may well be achieved by identification with the animus, but then the feminine side is left out in the cold. What is really necessary is that feminine intellectuality, logos in the woman, should be so fitted into the nature and life of the woman that a harmonious cooperation between the feminine and masculine factors ensues and no part is condemned to a shadowy existence" (Emma Jung - The Animus and Anima, p. 13).

"For when the feminine side is so overwhelmed and pushed into the background by the animus, there easily arise depressions, general dissatisfaction, and loss of interest in life. These are all

intelligible symptoms pointing to the fact that one half of the personality is partly robbed of life by the encroachment of the animus” (Emma Jung - The Animus and Anima, p. 15).

This *animus* identification has two main expressions, either the woman feels hopeless and powerless, or she adopts traditionally masculine traits in a very toxic manner, in both cases her relationships suffer. There needs to be a fine balance between the Eros and Logos principle, there isn't a recipe about how a man or woman should be, this is an individual pursuit. But we always have to remember that the conscious mind tends to be unilateral, so an over-identification with each side will always be destructive. Furthermore, developing the *animus* isn't about doing traditionally masculine things, it's something much deeper. It's about finding your own sense of meaning and direction in life. It's about crafting your own *cosmovision* and feeling fulfilled. It's about deeply knowing what you want, what's valuable to you, and going after it. It doesn't matter if you want to become an engineer or a dancer, what matters is if that's an authentic expression of your personality.

Nowadays, we see many women trying to get their power back, however, they end up adopting the worst facet possible of the masculine, and then they become toxic and destructive, not only to themselves but to everyone around them. Again, this is not developing the *animus*, it's simply becoming possessed by it. There always needs to be a balance between Eros and Logos, and each person has to discover what this means for them. In the previous chapter, we explored how the *animus* and *anima* make a pair of opposites with the *persona*, so when we're too identified with the *persona*, we're also subliminally identified with the *animus* and *anima*.

"One of the animus activities most difficult to see through lies in this field, namely, the building up of a wish-image of oneself. The animus is expert at sketching in and making plausible a picture that represents us as we would like to be seen, for example, as the “ideal lover,” the “appealing, helpless child,” the “selfless handmaiden,” the “extraordinarily original person”, “the one who is really born to something better,” and so on. This activity naturally lends the animus power over us until we voluntarily, or perforce, make up our minds to sacrifice the highly colored picture and see ourselves as we really are” (Emma Jung - The Animus and Anima, p. 19).

It's always important to challenge these labels and identities because they're our worst enemies. We have to pay close attention to the stories that we have been telling ourselves because

they rarely contain the whole truth. Opinions about how a woman should be and act are especially insidious because this prevents women from discovering their true individualities, there's no spontaneity. Also, this *animus* identification generates an inflation and women put themselves on a high horse dictating how everyone should be and act, they believe they own the truth and act like a judgmental tyrant. That's why Von Franz says that one way of escaping *animus* possession is by taking a humble attitude and dealing with your own *shadow*.

Lastly, anytime that you feel hopeless, powerless, and such a victim, you know that the *animus* is operating and you must challenge these thoughts and assumptions. Because another thing a negative *animus* promotes is this constant pondering about the past, about all your mistakes, about how you should've done things differently, and how things could be in the present moment, a bunch of "what ifs". This is not thinking, you're just indulging in a fantasy instead of dealing with what's right in front of you. Emma Jung says that the *animus* voice has mainly two ways of functioning, first it judges and criticizes absolutely everything a woman does, and second, it issues commands and prohibitions. Also, because the *animus* and Logos are impersonal, they tend to appear as a council of condemnatory judges, and less frequently as a single figure.

How To Deal With The Animus

At this point, you might be asking yourself, "So how to deal with these intrusive thoughts, opinions, and assumptions?". Well, since the *animus* is a *complex*, Barbara Hannah suggests that women have to personify the *animus*. This is actually a good idea to deal with any *complex*, because when we're able to personalize it, we create a separation between us, the conscious Ego, and this part, and this allows us to have a more objective perspective. At the same time that these figures are a part of us, they're also *autonomous complexes* with their own personalities and laws, and we have to get to know how they operate. So when you have a thought you have to ask yourself who inside you is thinking this and what is the part of yourself having these thoughts. This will help you detach from this automatism.

"One of the techniques that Jung recommends for getting acquainted with our animus is to keep a sharp lookout *on our* speech, in particular our thoughts, and to constantly question them as they pass through our minds: "Did I think that?" "Where did that thought come from?" "Who thought that?" This is a most disagreeable technique, and we always find good excuses to avoid it, such as

never having the time, and so on. But if we can force ourselves to practice it and to write down the outcome - for we forget such thoughts almost before we think them - the results can be exceedingly instructive” (Barbara Hannah - *The Animus*, p.17).

Women have to pay close attention to the stories they’re entertaining in their minds and question them. The first part is always to understand where a certain opinion comes from, for instance, if you have a fixed thought about how women should dress or the kind of work they can do. You can ask yourself where this comes from, a lot of the time you’ll discover that this is exactly how your mother or father viewed women, and you just absorbed it and never questioned it. Remember that in women, the *mother complex* serves as a basis for the *persona* and the *father complex* serves as a basis for the *animus*. But often, the negative *animus* of the mother is what shapes the sense of identity of the daughter, so pay special attention to that. A lot of this work will be focused on separating yourself from the parental figures, their values and beliefs, so as to create your own *cosmovision*. Obviously, not everything comes from the parents, so you have to question these thoughts and see if you can connect with any experiences you’ve had.

You’ll also discover that many thoughts don’t have a clear origin, and make no sense at all and this happens a lot during my sessions, I’ll hear an opinion and reflect it back, and the person suddenly realizes how crazy it is to think such things. One example I can remember is about this woman who wanted to create something new, but every time she had an idea she would research and see if someone had already talked about it, and obviously, she would always find something. She had this fixed idea that in order for something to be considered creative it had to be so original that no one had thought about it before.

Obviously this a crazy inhuman thought and this was preventing her from being creative. However, this woman was very artistic and she was a great writer and painter, but she never considered her creations original enough. That’s what the *animus* does, it makes you believe in these lies and prevents spontaneity and creativity. During the sessions, we challenged all of these opinions and she finally started to appreciate her own creations, furthermore, she understood that as long as she did it in her own way and added her own experience it would always be unique. Instead of operating with assumptions, she came up with her own beliefs around this.

I already said that to deal with the *animus* you have to question these thoughts, but sometimes this can be a trap and you get lost. What's important to understand is that these opinions prevent a woman from experiencing things as they are, she sees everything through these lenses, so what really matters when dealing with the *animus*, is to just experience reality as it is. For instance, if you want to relax and the *animus* voice keeps telling you how wrong this is, just tell him to shut up, and go enjoy yourself. If you're feeling guilty because you need your time alone or because you're doing something that is just for you, just tell him to be quiet, and go do your thing. Obviously, this advice is for someone who has a hard time doing that, because the *animus* can also be experienced as negative when he wants to push you forward but you're resisting.

Another example, many women feel guilty about pursuing a career or doing something that it's just for them that doesn't involve any relationships. When the Eros is overdeveloped it makes you lose your sense of identity in your relationships and you're always dependent on them. It makes a woman extremely passive and afraid, and she never pursues her individuality. However, a positive *animus* helps a woman to have this sense of direction, be driven, and create a life for herself that isn't dependent on others. However, if you resist acquiring this independence you'll forever remain in an infantile position, and most likely be identified with the *Puella Aeternus*.

The Animus Gift

The gift of the *animus* is to make a woman independent and uncover her true personality. But for it to happen, you have to devote time and learn how to consciously exert its function. It's really important to dedicate time to craft your own perception of life, your sense of identity, and your relationships. The first step is obviously to observe your opinions and question them. But we also have dream interpretation, active imagination, creative endeavors, and of course, analysis. Barbara Hannah says that writing is especially important for women as the word is the primary vehicle of the Logos.

When you write you have the chance to make these opinions conscious, at first, you should just allow them to come without any judgment. But after that is time to activate your critical mind and separate what makes sense and what doesn't. It's always important to insert your conscious perspective into these dialogues, so as to educate the *animus*. These inner figures also need to learn human values and limitations and you can find out more about this process on the active

imagination chapter. Lastly, artistic expressions like music or dancing are the realm of the Eros and there the *animus* can't touch you. So having an artistic outlet can be a great way of depotentiating the *animus*, and uncovering your authenticity. Finally, you have to dedicate time to craft your own *cosmovision* and develop your own sense of spirituality.

5.4 - The Anima - The Archetype of Life

As I revised this whole section and reread a few passages, it was very clear to me that defining the *anima* is way harder than defining the *animus*. This might be a bit obvious, but the Logos has a clear form and its main expression is the word, so it's something way easier to grasp. However, the *anima* is about the Eros principle and this immediately puts a few obstacles into having a precise definition. To be fair, Jung never attempted to define it either, as we know, he was an empiricist and was dedicated to describing the phenomenon and giving us a map to navigate them, rather than claiming to know the essence of something, as this would be a metaphysical statement. This is always a trap in psychology, people believe that just because they know a fancy name they know what the thing is, but this is just substituting reality with words. That said, I'll do my best to present the phenomenology of the *anima*, also knowing that it's impossible to grasp it without real experience. My intention is to give you some pointers so you can organize your own experience.

The Anima

Let's quickly recap that men have the tendency to be identified with the Logos so invariably they will have an unconscious Eros, and the unconscious has the tendency to be personified, so the image we find in the unconscious of men is denominated *anima*. Although the *anima* is harder to define, it's way easier to find it personified in artistic and religious expressions, as Jung says, the *anima* loves to show herself and tends to appear as a single entity.

"The anima is a factor of the utmost importance in the psychology of a man wherever emotions and affects are at work. She intensifies, exaggerates, falsifies, and mythologizes all emotional relations with his work and with other people of both sexes. The resultant fantasies and entanglements are all her doing. When the anima is strongly constellated, she softens the man's character and makes him touchy, irritable, moody, jealous, vain, and unadjusted. He is then in a state of "discontent" and

spreads discontent all around him. Sometimes the man's relationship to the woman who has caught his anima accounts for the existence of this syndrome" (C. G. Jung - V9.1 - §144).

The *anima* is closely related to the emotional life of a man and whenever we experience exaggerated reactions, a sense of urgency, and a general overwhelming feeling, that's the works of the *anima*. Here is a good place to differentiate between the *feeling function* and *affects*. Because the *feeling function* is the conscious experience of an emotion and it's about having a clear scale of values, whereas *affects* are about emotional reactions where we feel out of control. Consequently, the *anima* isn't about a *feeling* but about moods. In a general sense, most men are completely dissociated from their emotional life, and the ones that do have this connection, tend to be possessed by it, rather than having a conscious experience of their feelings. This is always something that threatens men and they usually do everything they can to run away from it, and when they do, the *anima* always has her revenge, entangling the man exactly in the situations he tries to avoid.

When Jung describes the *anima* he always points to poets, novels, and art, because this is the realm of the Eros, and it's not something that can be logically explained. Again, the Eros is about irrationality, and Jung explains that he really means that this is extra rational, it has its own laws and way of functioning that are different from logical reason. I mean, good luck trying to explain what love is, it's just impossible, we can only relate when we've had the experience, and only symbolic and artistic expressions can properly convey it. Whenever you hear a love song, or someone dedicating his art to an unreachable and perfect muse, that's the *anima*. Also, the *anima* has many facets like the Great Mother, the Prophetess, and the Love Goddess, an *archetype* encompasses all forms of expression, and each one of this symbols reveals one aspect of the feminine.

"Because the anima, as the feminine aspect of man, possesses this receptivity and absence of prejudice toward the irrational, she is designated the mediator between consciousness and the unconscious. In the creative man, especially, this feminine attitude plays an important role; it is not without cause that we speak of the conception of a work, of carrying out a thought, delivering oneself of it, or brooding over it" (Emma Jung - The Animus and Anima, p. 53).

"The anima represents the connection with the spring or source of life in the unconscious. When no such connection exists, or when it is broken, a state of stagnation or torpor results, often so

disturbing that it causes the person involved to seek out a psychiatrist” (Emma Jung - The Animus and Anima, p. 64).

The *anima* is linked with the collective unconscious which is the source of life and inspiration in a man’s life. When you have this connection you feel energized and alive, life acquires a deeper layer of experience that revitalizes your *soul*. It gives a man the capacity to relate to the depths of his being and create profound relationships, and have a sense of meaning. That’s why when men are too identified with the Logos and reject everything that has to do with the feminine, they become dry and the only way the Eros has of expressing itself is in a toxic manner. Once again we have to remember that the *anima* is a compensation for the *persona*, and there’s a tendency in men to be overly identified with traditional masculinity and believe that feminine values are inferior.

With this strong *persona* identification, there’s also a subliminal *anima* identification that makes men extremely vain and shallow, he only values prestige and lives for appearances. Instead of having real relationships he lives superficially and will seek for that trophy wife, and this is the perfect match for a woman who’s identified with her body and is only interested in having power and status through her relationships. Sex and emotional connection are often dissociated from one another, and one of the main reasons men get addicted to sex is because it substitutes intimacy and the connection with their own *souls*. Also, you might think that men who have a connection with art like painters or musicians have a good relationship with their *anima*, but this is often not the case, because if you’re identified with your *persona*, you’ll use your art as a means to boost your ego, it’ll never be something genuine. So men try to possess the *anima*, like having a collection of art that they don’t even know how to truly appreciate, but serves to boost their status when they host fancy dinners. Speaking of which, the field of critics, like food critics or cinema critics, is filled with pompous men possessed by their *anima*. They only care for aesthetics, nothing is ever good enough, and they’re always in a bad mood and spread this discontent to everyone.

When you’re too focused on aesthetics you completely kill the creative force of the *anima*, there’s no *soul* or inspiration. Here I can give you a really simple example, whenever I’m composing music I have to accommodate these two sides, one is the creative side trying to be expressed and the other is trying to order and put form into everything. However, when I’m too focused on aesthetics I get lost in trying to find the perfect chord, the sequence that will make the

most sense, or how people are going to judge my lyrics, and this absolutely kills the process. The *anima* demands a genuine expression and when it doesn't find an outlet, the only way the *anima* has to express itself is through anxiety, depression, all forms of addiction, and in extreme cases it crushes the masculine spirit, and the man becomes spineless and weak. Funny enough, most men think that by giving space to the Eros they will become effeminate or emasculated, but it's actually the other way around. Also, you're supposed to accommodate the Eros with the conscious Logos, it's always a dialectical procedure.

Emma Jung says that "It is not a question of either surrendering his masculinity completely to the service of the Lady Anima or losing her entirely, but only of granting a certain space to the feminine, which is also a part of his being. This he does by recognizing and realizing the eros, the principle of relationship, which means that he not only becomes aware of his feeling, but also makes use of it, because to create, and especially to preserve, a relationship, a value judgment (which is what feeling is) cannot be dispensed with. A man by nature tends to relate to objects, to his work, or to some other field of interest; but what matters to a woman is the personal relation, and this is true also of the anima. Her tendency is to entangle a man in such relationships, but she can also serve him well in giving them shape — that is, she can do so after the feminine element has been incorporated into consciousness. As long as this element works autonomously, it disturbs relations or makes them impossible" (Emma Jung - The Animus and Anima, p. 77).

When the *anima* is not conscious it becomes dissociated and functions like an *autonomous complex* that always appears in unwanted ways, especially when a man is being demanded emotionally and he doesn't have any sensibility, he has fits of rage, and becomes touchy, jealous, and over-sentimental. Also, if he doesn't have a firm Logos, he becomes indecisive, afraid, insecure, and lost. Now he either kills every relationship because he doesn't have any emotional capacity and is always an ogre, or he becomes clingy and suffocates everyone. That's why there needs to be a balance between Eros and Logos, as the Eros has to be incorporated to the masculine spirit. If a man doesn't cultivate a sense of direction, drive, organization, decisiveness, and discipline, the *anima* completely crushes him. However, when men have a conscious experience of the *anima* they know what's truly valuable to them, they know what's meaningful, and are decisive about it.

The Archetype of Life

That's why Jung also describes the *anima* as the archetype of life: "As usual, there is something in what the anima says; for life in itself is not good only, it is also bad. Because the anima wants life, she wants both good and bad. These categories do not exist in the elfin realm. Bodily life as well as psychic life have the impudence to get along much better without conventional morality, and they often remain the healthier for it"(C. G. Jung - V9.1 - §59).

The *anima* is what presents a man with his call to adventure and is associated with flings of courage and bravery. The *anima* always challenges a man to find what's truly valuable to him and demands that he take a stance and take decisive action. When you don't consciously have this sense of direction and meaning, the *anima* keeps entangling a man into situations where he has to face that, and this will happen especially with women, because when you don't cultivate that internally, this will be invariably projected upon women, and now they become your reason to exist. Women become your life and purpose, and there's this expectation that they will fulfill your every need.

This is exactly what happens with men who become pick-up artists, obviously, this is completely narcissistic and unreasonable, but this one of the reasons why men feel devastated when a relationship ends. They projected their *soul* on a woman and now that she doesn't correspond to this absurd demand, because no human being can or should, they feel like a piece of them is gone. This is somewhat true, but instead of trying to find someone else to fill this hole, you should establish a connection with your own *soul*. When you do that, the *anima* becomes your helper. By the way, I'm talking mainly about women, but the exact same thing happens between homosexual men. The *anima* invites a man to fully engage in life, while the *animus* cuts a woman from her relationships and reality. That's why men need a more decisive and direct approach in dealing with the *anima*, while for a woman she often just needs to avoid the traps of her *animus*.

The Eros Principle

Also, the Eros always invites us to relativize conventional values, not in a sense to become immoral, but to become more flexible and learn how to entertain and sustain paradoxes. Logos always operates with clear categories of good and evil, however, there are many things that happen

that initially can be judged as bad but turn out to be good, and vice-versa. For instance, suffering and pain are always judged as bad, however, it's a necessary condition for psychological maturity. Why? ... Because you have to sacrifice part of your current personality and conscious values so as to give room to something new. It's painful and very laborious dealing with our *shadow* and *complexes*, the ego always clings to old ways, but through this pain, a new balanced personality can arise.

I'm guilty of that too, when I started as a therapist I had many insecurities and I used to do everything I could to help my patients get out of that estate as quickly as I could because I didn't know how to allow things to happen in their own time. However, I had many experiences, including a few active imaginations, showing me the value of suffering and how this can teach many lessons that can completely reshape our lives. Logos tend to be forceful and direct, and many times this approach doesn't yield the best results. Eros comes and gives you the sensibility to know the best words to use, in a way that disarms people, and give you patience to know the right time to reflect something back, because if you're always forceful you often meet shut doors and block the process.

I'm very intuitive and I often know exactly what's going on in the first few sessions, however, a lot of people are not ready to hear it, and there needs to be a whole construction before I can say certain things, this sensibility comes from the Eros. Also, many times preventing people from suffering only keeps them in a childish position. It's like that overprotective devouring mother who doesn't allow her children to experience the world. You have to learn when to let people figure things out on their own and also know that some things take time and get resolved on their own, you just have to sustain the paradox, and from it, a new synthesis arises.

The Goddess of Illusion

Now, Jung tells us that the main component that conditions the *anima* is the *parental complex*. Let's quickly recap that in men, the *father complex* serves as a basis for the *persona* and the *mother complex* as a basis for the *anima*. Consequently, the relationship with the real mother has a great impact on the *anima*, as well as how the father deals with the feminine. In *Aion* Jung equates the *anima* with Maya, the goddess of illusion, because the *anima* is constantly interjecting in our interpretation of reality:

"What, then, is this projection-making factor? The East calls it the "Spinning Woman"—Maya, who creates illusion by her dancing. Had we not long since known it from the symbolism of dreams, this hint from the Orient would put us on the right track: the enveloping, embracing, and devouring element points unmistakably to the mother, that is, to the son's relation to the real mother, to her imago, and to the woman who is to become a mother for him. His Eros is passive like a child's; he hopes to be caught, sucked in, enveloped, and devoured. He seeks, as it were, the protecting, nourishing, charmed circle of the mother, the condition of the infant released from every care, in which the outside world bends over him and even forces happiness upon him. No wonder the real world vanishes from sight!" (C. G. Jung - V9.2 - §20).

"If this situation is dramatized, as the unconscious usually dramatizes it, then there appears before you on the psychological stage a man living regressively, seeking his childhood and his mother, fleeing from a cold cruel world which denies him understanding. Often a mother appears beside him who apparently shows not the slightest concern that her little son should become a man, but who, with tireless and self-immolating effort, neglects nothing that might hinder him from growing up and marrying. You behold the secret conspiracy between mother and son, and how each helps the other to betray life" (C. G. Jung - V9.2 - §21).

When a man is caught in his *mother complex*, there's a tendency to live regressively, always looking back and wanting to remain a child. He resists carving his own path and becomes indecisive, insecure, and weak. He attempts to escape and live his own life only to find himself giving up and coming back the next moment. The relationship with the devouring mother makes a man averse to touch reality, he lives in a fantastical and magical world where everything is given to him and he doesn't have to do any work. This also conditions his expectations about women, he believes that he will find that magical being that will give him this sense of eternal childhood and will take care of him like a dedicated mother. He expects the woman to allow him to be a child and not place any demands that he become a grown man. Of course, I'm talking about the *Puer Aeternus*, but I'm not gonna dive deep into this here since I've already covered that. But I'd like to leave you with one more quote:

"The spirit of evil is fear, negation, the adversary who opposes life in its struggle for eternal duration and thwarts every great deed, who infuses into the body the poison of weakness and age through the treacherous bite of the serpent; he is the spirit of regression, who threatens us with

bondage to the mother and with dissolution and extinction in the unconscious. For the hero, fear is a challenge and a task, because only boldness can deliver from fear. And if the risk is not taken, the meaning of life is somehow violated.” (C. G. Jung - V5 - §551).

That’s why the *anima* always has to be balanced with the masculine spirit, which means knowing what you want and taking decisive action to achieve that. The *anima* demands that you get your hands dirty and have the audacity to carve your own path. When you’re walking according to the values of your soul and following your *pistis*, the *anima* becomes your most faithful helper, she unravels her secrets, gives you reassurance, and gifts you with meaning and aliveness. Finding your true path is the main challenge the *anima* imposes, and she only reveals herself to those who prove to be worthy.

How To Deal With The Anima

Now, how should we deal with the *anima*?

"The motive of the imprisonment of the animus has its counterpart in masculine psychology in the imprisonment of the anima, but it is naturally different in that it is concerned with emotions and moods. When a man is able to make a difference between the objective situation and his mood, when he no longer allows his mood to blindfold his mind, when he can set it apart, acknowledge that he has a peculiar mood, that is the beginning of the imprisonment of the anima. After a while he will be able to say to his mood: “You have no right to exist, I will put you into a test tube and you shall be analyzed.” Of course this means a great sacrifice, it can only be done with blood, it requires a superhuman effort to bottle up the anima. So I quite recognize what an extraordinary accomplishment it is for a woman to put the animus aside, to say, “I will put you into a test tube for later analysis” (Barbara Hannah - The Animus, p. 133).

With any *complex*, it’s always important to cultivate an objective perspective so our conscious ego can detach from its *affects*. With the *anima*, keeping our emotional reactions in check is crucial, as they tend to cloud our judgments and promote actions that we almost always regret. When the *anima* is constellated there’s always a sense of urgency, for the Eros doesn’t deal with time like the conscious mind do, it always wants everything now. That’s why giving it time and

allowing the inner turmoil to pass is a great piece of wisdom. With time, you start acquiring a certain sensibility to know when you're being triggered, and instead of giving in, you must take a step back and analyze this particular mood before you take action.

Perhaps you don't have the self-control to do that in the moment, that's why it's wise to be alone and wait until you calm down before making any decisions. Once you do, it's important to understand why you felt those things, and what are the patterns involved. There's also another possibility, with extremely passive men, the *anima* might be trying to compensate for this lack of action, so instead of being trapped in paralysis by analysis, this impulse is demanding that you make a decision and do something about it. That's why the *anima* is also associated with flings of courage and bravery, and the more you make your own values conscious the less you'll feel this overwhelming pull.

When dealing with the *anima* we have two main tendencies. If you're too identified with the Logos, the *anima* probably doesn't have any space in your life, and she is demanding that you open yourself and stop being so rigid, that way you can also entertain feminine values. Alternatively, we have men possessed by their *anima*, and this touchiness and sentimentality has to be balanced with developing your masculine spirit and taking a stance in life. Either way, both need to develop a conscious expression of their feminine side, and again this is always a dialectical procedure, and you have to find your own balance between Eros and Logos.

6 - The Art of Dream Interpretation

Now that we've touched upon the basic aspects of Jungian Psychology, we're ready to further our exploration with Carl Jung's method on dream interpretation, here's where everything comes to life. Shall we begin with a quote from Marie Von Franz:

"The dream one gets at night is always like a letter from the same inner center, from the Self. Every dream is that, and the writer of the letter is always the same: the Self, the one thing, the *quid*" (Marie Von Franz - Alchemical Active Imagination, p. 67).

Learning how to trust and follow these authentic letters is one of the things that had the most impact on my psychological development. Whenever I'm analyzing my dreams I feel like I'm tapping into this eternal source of knowledge that holds the key to the *Self*. We must approach it with reverence and learn its symbolic language in order to establish a dialogue with the depths of our being. This profound experience has brought me an immense degree of confidence that I'm on the right path and is constantly teaching me how to solve my own problems. Sometimes I get kicked in the face, while other times I'm reminded of my true capabilities.

6.1 - The Prospective Nature of the Psyche

"As most people know, one of the basic principles of analytical psychology is that dream-images are to be understood symbolically; that is to say, one must not take them literally, but must surmise a hidden meaning in them" (C. G. Jung - V5 – §4).

Learning to interpret dreams feels like we're learning a new idiom, in this case, the symbolic and metaphorical language of the unconscious. It's important to understand that the unconscious isn't bound to moral standards and the laws of time and continuity as our conscious mind is, that's why when analyzing its material, we have to hold opposing perspectives. Jung establishes that "When a psychological fact has to be explained, it must be remembered that psychological data necessitate a twofold point of view, namely that of *causality* and that of *finality*" (C. G. Jung - V8 – §456).

In that sense, Jung proposes that we must hold the paradox *why and what for?*: “In psychological matters, the question “Why does it happen?” is not necessarily more productive of results than the other question “To what purpose does it happen?” (C. G. Jung - V8 – §530). This means that we can’t interpret unconscious images solely based on causality, that is, seeking to understand the origin and the story behind it, this is only half of the equation, and often gets us stuck in the past, and promotes a regressive attitude.

By working with these two points of view, Jung was able to incorporate both the Freudian and Adlerian perspectives into his psychology, as the basis of the *individuation process* also lies in the prospective quality of the *psyche*, that is, there’s a sense of purpose and a goal to be achieved by the unconscious and the *Self*. In a sense, the *psyche* creates its own future. “The causal standpoint merely inquires how this psyche has become what it is, as we see it today. The constructive standpoint asks how, out of this present psyche, a bridge can be built into its own future” (C. G. Jung - V3 – §399).

Working with this paradox is one of the things that make Jungian Psychology so unique, and putting this into practice can be really simple. I had a patient who had many dreams revolving around the military and every time he had a visceral reaction of disgust. This is not a surprise, since his father was absent and worked for the police force. Simply put, they didn’t get along well and he was carrying many wounds from this relationship. Now, interpreting the military symbol through the reductive perspective invariably takes us to his *father complex*, to his past all the stories and memories associated with it. This is an important step to understand how our internal dynamics were formed and how they’re operating, but it isn’t enough.

At that moment, he was still living with his mother, was struggling to build discipline, and truly commit to finding his own path in life. He was hesitating to become an adult and the qualities that would help him move further were all present in the military symbol. There’s an interesting thing that happens, when we can only appreciate something negatively we also can’t incorporate the positive traits of it. The military can be seen as hostile, violent, and tyrannical. However, in his case, it was compensating for his lack of attitude, discipline, and seeking to become independent.

As the months passed, his perspective about the military symbol started to shift and with it, he also experienced changes in the real world. The prospective portion of the military symbol was

propelling him to grow and overcome his *father complex*, it anticipated a development of his personality. After two years of working together, he had become independent, disciplined, and committed to his craft. Before, he could only appreciate authority in a negative way and this also prevented him from occupying any leadership position. Once he integrated this military symbol by transforming his *conscious attitude*, he was able to conquer authority over his own life, he was finally able to bear more responsibility and become a leader in his work. At last, he overcame his *father complex* and became independent.

6.2 - The Mechanics of Dream Interpretation

Now let's move to the mechanics of dream interpretation. One thing that we must always have in mind is that the relationship between conscious and unconscious is *compensatory/complementary*. Also, the *conscious attitude* acts by *selecting – directing – excluding*, and everything that is incompatible with conscious values will either be repressed or simply remain unconscious. These incompatible contents are precisely what will appear in dreams, as everything that was forsaken has the mission to balance our *conscious attitude*. If this process isn't clear to you, I strongly recommend that you pause and go back to the first chapter on *psychodynamics*.

Dream Interpretation Phases

"[...] The dream is a spontaneous self-portrayal, in symbolic form, of the actual situation in the unconscious" (C. G. Jung - V8 – §505).

Now it's time to go through the process of dream interpretation. In this light, I brought a very simple structure Jung proposes in *Structure and Dynamics of The Psyche* to analyze dreams:

- **Dream phases:** Introduction (exposition) – *Peripetia* – *Lysis* (culmination or ending).
- **Important elements:** Local and *Dramatis Personae*.

When interpreting dreams, we have to pay close attention to the story that's being told. It helps to envision them as if we were watching a play unfolding in our minds. It's crucial to

understand the narrative and have a clear storyline. Understanding the right sequence of events and the exact steps each character takes is key. It's interesting to write dreams as if they were separated by different acts, try to be as thorough as you can with your descriptions. Here, it is important to remember that our *psyche* is structured around four different functions, so seek to engage your *thinking, feeling, sensation, and intuition* when describing the scenes and characters.

The first act is the *introduction*, and we can pair it with describing the *local* where everything takes place. What is the first thing you remember? And how's the environment of this dream? The second act is the *peripetia*, in other words, what actually happens in the dream. What adventures or misadventures you're engaged in? The third and final act is the *lysis*. This is the most important one, as it will reveal what the dream is *compensating* for. In other words, in which direction the *Self* is trying to take us in order to establish the right balance again.

The First Step

Jung says that "When we take up an obscure dream, our first task is not to understand and interpret but to establish the context with minute care. By this, I do *not* mean unlimited "free association" starting from any and every image in the dream, but a careful and conscious illumination of the interconnected associations objectively grouped around particular images" (C. G. Jung - V16.2 – §319). He continues by saying that "Free association will bring out all my complexes, but hardly ever the meaning of a dream. To understand the dream's meaning I must stick as close as possible to the dream images" (C. G. Jung - V16.2 – §320).

The first thing we ought to do is to gather our *personal amplifications* (aka associations), following a *circumambulatory process*. For instance, let's say there's an important sword in the dream. What do you think about this sword? What emotions or personal stories are associated with it? What is the material and the design? How do you perceive this sword in the dream? What is the particular meaning this sword has to you? We have to follow this process with every single image and character in the dream. That's why seeking recipes and meanings on Google is nonsense. The true meaning always lies within and is unraveled by following this process.

Marie Von Franz on *amplification*:

“Making associations around a theme means plunging it back into the unconscious for a brief moment [...] The main point is to focus especially on emotional qualities and sensitivity, not definitions. [...] you need to really try to rescue the original richness of what that image conveys. That’s why we amplify, and that’s the right way to go. Amplifying means going back as far below the threshold as possible, and reliving those pervasive emotional ideas, sensations, and reactions we have about something”.

When we’re amplifying we have to be constantly looking at the dream images and seek to understand how they relate to one another. It’s imperative to be careful to not get sidetracked by unrelated stories or generic meanings. It’s only when we’re out of *personal amplifications* that we can start looking for more collective understandings, so as to enrich our interpretation, such as mythological and archetypal motives.

Jung also explores the notion of *relatively fixed symbols*, this means that certain images have the tendency to point to a particular meaning. For instance, the child tends to symbolize renewal, potential, possibilities, and the birth of something new. However, this is rather vague, even though the symbol of the child might bear this meaning, what’s important is to understand how this fits a particular situation. Saying that such a symbol means this or that is just a lazy interpretation, and that’s why dream analysis tends to have a bad reputation. Even though we have *relatively fixed symbols*, we have to uncover their meaning for a particular person and how they’re operating in their *psyche*.

Subjective x Objective Interpretation

The next step is figuring out if the images should be interpreted on the *subjective level* or the *objective level*. In other words, when we’re supposed to interpret the images as a subjective part of ourselves or a concrete relationship with the outer world. For instance, when we see our best friend in the dream, do I interpret it as a part of my personality? Or as my actual friend in real life?

Well, Jung says that in about 90% of the cases, dreams should be interpreted on the *subjective level*, and that objective interpretations only become more frequent when someone is really advanced in their *individuation process*. However, sometimes we can have a *mixed*

interpretation, this tends to happen when the character in the dream is close to the dreamer. In this situation, it's important to uncover the projections that might be happening, and at the same time, find guidance in how to deal with said person. Archetypal dreams, or *big dreams*, are also rarer. When we're confronted with images from the collective unconscious, we'll need knowledge of mythological motives. But even though we're dealing with collective and primordial images, it's imperative to understand what role they're playing in a particular individual. So, in a sense, the interpretation will also be individual.

The Inner Theater

For the majority of dreams, we should follow this:

“The whole dream-work is essentially subjective, and a dream is a theatre in which the dreamer is himself the scene, the player, the prompter, the producer, the author, the public, and the critic. This simple truth forms the basis for a conception of the dream's meaning which I have called *interpretation on the subjective level*. Such an interpretation, as the term implies, conceives all the figures in the dream as personified features of the dreamer's own personality” (C. G. Jung - V8 – §509).

Continuing the “play” metaphor, in order to properly interpret a dream, we have to first understand its story. Right after, we have to gather our *personal amplifications* of every image and character in the dream. We must take these images with absolute seriousness and as parts of our personality. These characters are also known as *complexes*, which are “The architects of dreams and every symptom” (C. G. Jung - V8 - §210). As we've already seen, *complexes* are the real puppet masters behind every neurotic symptom, misunderstandings in relationships, and repeating patterns.

During our sleep, we get to watch our own internal dynamics unfold before our eyes, where every character portrays our psychological tendencies. The way we react and the choices we make reveal how we've been dealing with or how we should've been dealing with the matters presented. As Jung says, dreams “Show the inner truth and reality of the patient as it really is: not as I conjecture it to be, and not as he would like it to be, but *as it is*” (C. G. Jung - V16.2 – §304). In this

light, dreams, through a symbolic language, will give us an objective view of ourselves and the situations we're currently experiencing. As the unconscious contents are so contrary to our conscious values, there's always the tendency to dismiss it, appreciate it only negatively, or even distort its message to fit our narratives. That's why dream interpretation demands courage and humility to see the raw reality of who we are.

Lysis

“If we want to interpret a dream correctly, we need a thorough knowledge of the conscious situation at that moment, because the dream contains its unconscious complement, that is, the material which the conscious situation has constellated in the unconscious. Without this knowledge, it is impossible to interpret a dream correctly, except by a lucky fluke” (C. G. Jung - V8 – §477).

Lastly, after we've gathered all the information we need, such as *personal* and *objective amplifications*, and the context has been established with minute care, it's time to understand what is the dream *compensating*. Let's remember that the relationship between conscious and unconscious is *compensatory/ complementary*. Jung says that “The essence of the individuation process, which, according to all we know, lies at the base of psychological compensation” (C. G. Jung - V8 – §553). In this light, dreams are already a healing attempt and they're constantly seeking to correct our *conscious attitude*. By *attitude*, we can also understand the way we've been going about life and how we've been treating our inner and outer life, this will always be the single most important piece of information for interpretation to take place.

6.3 - The Psychodynamics of Dream Compensation

“From all this it should now be clear why I make it a heuristic rule, in interpreting a dream, to ask myself: What conscious attitude does it compensate? By so doing, I relate the dream as closely as possible to the conscious situation; indeed, I would even assert that without knowledge of the conscious situation, the dream can never be interpreted with any degree of certainty. Only in the light of this knowledge is it possible to make out whether the unconscious content carries a plus or a minus sign” (C. G. Jung - V16.2 – §334).

It's only after we have a thorough understanding of the *conscious attitude* that it's possible to properly interpret a dream. We also have to work with the premise that we do have an *optimum vital point*. This happens when consciousness is at the perfect balance between the demands of the outer world (*persona*) and the demands of the inner world (individuation). Therefore, compensation means, equilibrating or substituting our *conscious attitude*, by comparing different data or points of view, so as to produce an adjustment or a rectification.

Finally, knowing that the relationship between the ego complex and the unconscious is *compensatory/ complementary*, we have three possibilities (C. G. Jung - V8 – §546):

- If the conscious attitude to the life situation is in large degree one-sided, then the dream takes the opposite side.
- If the conscious has a position fairly near the “middle,” the dream is satisfied with variations.
- If the conscious attitude is “correct” (adequate), then the dream coincides with and emphasizes this tendency, though without forfeiting its peculiar autonomy.

Examples

To illustrate this, Jung gives us a very simple example in *Practice of Psychotherapy*. Pay close attention to how the interpretation changes depending on the *conscious attitude*. First, a young man dreams of a horse jumping over a ravine. His *conscious attitude* is always hesitant and he's scared to pursue his own path in life, so the dream is telling him to be bold and take risks. After all, the first half of life is meant to seek expansion and strengthen the ego complex. Now, a man in his mid-50s has the exact same dream, but his *conscious attitude* was always courageous and he was able to conquer his life. This dream is showing him how he's been acting and the origins of his neurosis, now it's time to leave this youthful attitude behind. In the second half of life, energy must be directed to enrich his inner life.

Assimilation

“For dream-contents to be assimilated, it is of overriding importance that no real values of the conscious personality should be damaged, much less destroyed, otherwise there is no one left to do the assimilating. [...] We must see to it that the values of the conscious personality remain intact, for unconscious compensation is only effective when it co-operates with an integral consciousness. Assimilation is never a question of “this *or* that,” but always of “this *and* that” (C. G. Jung - V16.2 – §338).

Interpreting dreams is always a challenge to our *conscious attitude*, and maintaining our ground can be difficult at times. But we always have to remember that dream analysis is a dialectical procedure between our conscious values and the perspective of the unconscious. Integrating the message of a dream requires a moral confrontation since the unconscious isn't bound to any morals or the laws of time and continuity. Many times the dream will show something completely exacerbated “to make a point” and we can't blindly follow that and completely abandon our current values. We always have to find the middle ground and understand how these symbols fit into our lives. The *Self* only points in the right direction, but the conscious mind has to direct the process, plan, and make decisions.

6.4 - General Guidelines

“Analysis consists of educating people to be able to hear their inner voice and to follow it with the help of dreams” (Marie Von Franz).

Dream interpretation is an art and only practice can make you good at it. The way I learned to interpret dreams was by first working with an analyst myself, devouring Jung's *collected works*, and then interpreting countless dreams of my patients. Nowadays, I'm confident interpreting most of my dreams and they have become a valuable compass on my journey. But every now and then, I still have some dreams that get me absolutely puzzled for days and I have to seek help. After all, dealing with the unconscious is a lengthy and laborious process. Von Franz also used to say that trying to interpret our own dreams is like trying to see our own backs, as dreams always come from our blind spots and reveal what we don't know. Rushing with interpretations is often a sign that we interpreted them through the lenses of our *neurosis*. That's why a thorough understanding of our

conscious attitude and psychological tendencies is imperative, otherwise, you'll just remain with neurotic interpretations.

That said, I'll leave a few extra tips for interpreting dreams:

- Always interpret the characters subjectively first, as there's a great chance you're watching your own *complexes*.
- Always interpret dreams in a positive and a negative light, be careful if you're enamored with one perspective.
- Always interpret dreams through a reductive and prospective perspective – “Why and what for?”.
- In the beginning, don't make any major decisions, rushing can be a sign of a neurotic interpretation.
- Always remember that dreams come from your *inferior function* and interpreting it only with your *main function* will be a neurotic interpretation.

Lastly, Jung used to say that the only criteria for a dream being successfully interpreted was if it helped the patient move forward. In other words, if the interpretation unlocks new perspectives and a new *attitude* that can solve the matter at hand. Plus, a degree of certainty only comes after analyzing a series of dreams.

7 - Active Imagination Deciphered

Active imagination is the most disruptive endeavor Carl Jung partook in. As he says, he didn't invent it, he simply rediscovered it. However, he took this practice to new heights and gave us a map and a terminology capable of capturing and translating the dynamism of the *psyche* into words, giving more people the gift of experimenting for themselves. I've been doing active imagination for about three years now and it's been a great tool to unlock new perspectives and access new depths.

7.1 - The Mirrored World

Before we dive into active imagination, it's important to remember the notion of *psychic reality* and Carl Jung's attitude toward metaphysics: "[...] It is really my purpose to push aside, without mercy, the metaphysical claims of all esoteric teaching" [...] To understand metaphysically is impossible ; it can only be done psychologically I therefore strip things of their metaphysical wrappings in order to make them objects of psychology (C. G. Jung - The Secret of The Golden Flower – p. 129). By adopting the notion of a *psychic reality*, the active imagination realm works like a mirrored world and portrays the reality of our *soul*. It unravels a symbolic representation of what we're currently experiencing and uncovers the archetypal narrative we're living. It gives us the key to develop a symbolic attitude and apprehend the mystery of the *Self*.

On Active Imagination

But perhaps, you're asking yourself why it was so important to explore the notion of *psychic reality*, in the first place. Well, during active imagination we will be dealing with these *psychic images* directly and it's important to be able to maintain an objective perspective. We'll be accessing the very fabric of our reality and uncovering the deep psychological factors that are driving our *psyche*, namely *complexes* and *archetypes*. The main purpose is to deal with psychological *complexes* in a personified form and as you know they are autonomous, every aspect of the *shadow*, the psychological functions, and the *animus* and *anima* are all perceived as *complexes*.

“But, for the reasons given above, it is essential that nothing be subtracted from the reality of the unconscious, and that the figures of the unconscious should be understood as quantities which produce effects. Whoever has understood the thing meant by psychic reality need not fear falling back into primitive demonology because that reality is admitted. If the unconscious figures are not accorded the dignity of spontaneously effective factors, one becomes the victim of a one-sided belief in the conscious, which finally leads to a state of mental tension. Catastrophes are then bound to occur, because, despite all one’s consciousness, the dark psychic powers have been overlooked. It is not we who personify them ; they have a personal nature from the very beginning” (C. G. Jung - The Secret Of The Golden Flower p. 119).

To better understand this notion, I want you to imagine that every psychological state has a correspondent psychic image. To fully grasp a *psychic image* we need the four functions, this means that every image possesses a thinking pattern, an emotional state and judgment of value, unique fantasies, and patterns of behavior.

To make this really simple, just connect yourself with a loving feeling. This same feeling can turn into a poem, a nice and beautiful melody, it can lead you to imagine yourself with a loved one watching a beautiful sunset, it’s accompanied by physical sensations, and you feel your body warm and your heart racing, and it can also be turned into action, and you find yourself wanting to give a meaningful gift. See? ... These *psychic images* are alive and are constantly driving our *psyche*. Every artist or creative person knows that, it’s an inspiration that completely overwhelms us. We are the object of this creative spirit and during a moment of inspiration, we allow it to move through us.

What happens during active imagination, is that we’re relating to these factors in a very direct way. Imagine that this force that allows us to compose a beautiful song can be personified. Try to imagine that it could be a person, how would it speak and act? This is just a little exercise to help you understand what we can encounter during the active imagination sessions. But the best way to understand it is to think about when we’re lucid dreaming. Sometimes it feels so real that we believe it happened in the concrete world. The characters we interact with during dreams are the personified *complexes*, the driving forces that shape our *psyche*. They reveal our deepest psychological tendencies and how we relate to them determines how they are going to be

expressed. This is the most important part and why active imagination is so different from any other method.

During every form of meditation, hypnotherapy, or yoga nidra, the goal is always to let go and to detach ourselves from our conscious ego. It's a very passive procedure. Now, during active imagination we need our ego-complex completely intact and we'll be the ones directing the process. We have to make decisions, argue, ask questions, and challenge these inner figures. We need an ego complex that's strong enough to contain the unconscious, i.e. capable of holding opposing and complementary truths at the same time. Not only that, but an ego complex capable of maintaining an objective perspective and not being identified with these figures. Because if you identify yourself with these *archetypes* you'll experience psychic inflation. That's when things can go badly, and we see megalomaniac people thinking they are the next incarnation of Jesus.

Active Imagination and Its Dangers

That's why this procedure obviously has to be done with caution and has its dangers, the most poignant one is *psychosis*. If you're just curious and want to experiment with something different just don't do it. If you're not established in real life yet and have no real responsibilities don't do it, you need solid roots in reality to be doing this.

During his confrontation with the unconscious, Carl Jung was raising a family, seeing several patients a day, and working for the Swiss army. He never neglected his commitments to real life and that's a major part of constituting a strong ego-complex. Every time you hesitate in life and indulge in fantasies, you're bound to face the dark and devouring facet of the unconscious. This is often the case with the *Puer* and *Puella Aeternus*. Active imagination is meant to be a support to better live your life, not a magical place you can escape to.

Lastly, If you're using any kind of drugs, yes, even weed. Don't do it. In this case, your ego-complex isn't engaged in the process. You can read more about that in the book "Psychotherapy" by Marie Von Franz. Finally, always remember that the unconscious reacts to our *conscious attitude*. As Jung writes in *Psychology and Alchemy*: "We know that the mask of the unconscious is not rigid

—it reflects the face we turn towards it. Hostility lends it a threatening aspect, friendliness softens its features” (C. G. Jung - V12 – §29).

7.2 - When is Active Imagination advised?

From the book “Inner Journey” by Barbara Hannah:

1. “When the unconscious is obviously overflowing with fantasies, which is particularly often the case with people who are very rational or intellectual”.
2. “To reduce the number of dreams when there are too many”.
3. “A third reason for doing active imagination is when there are too few dreams”.
4. ”If someone feels, or seems to be, under indefinable influences, under a sort of spell, or feels or seems to be behind a sort of glass screen”.
5. “When the adaptation to life has been injured“.
6. “When someone falls into the same hole again and again”.

This is a seminar taught by Babara Hannah, Jung personally attended to it and answered questions in the end. It’s worth the read.

7.3 - The Procedure – A step-by-step approach

From the book “Psychotherapy” by Marie Von Franz:

1. As we know, first one must empty one’s own ego consciousness, free oneself from the thought flow of the ego.

This is where regular meditation techniques can be helpful to put you on the right psychological state. Once this is achieved, you can just open yourself and allow the unconscious to manifest itself. However, I find it extremely helpful to have certain departure points and concentrate on them, these are the ones that tend to give the most results:

- *Affects.*
- Dream fragments.
- A genuine question.
- Spontaneous fantasies.
- A narrative or repeating pattern.

You simply pick one of them and try your best to match the psychological state of when you’re experiencing it and allow things to unfold in your mind.

2. At this point one must let a fantasy image arising from the unconscious flow into the field of inner perception.

Remember that *psychic images* have four layers. Maybe you won’t see anything, but you’ll

hear a word and even have physical sensations. The most important thing is to allow yourself to sink into the *affects* provided by these *psychic images* deeper and deeper.

3. Now comes the third phase. It consists of giving the innerly perceived fantasy image a form by writing it down, painting it, sculpting it, writing it as music, or dancing it (in which case the movements of the dance must be noted down).

It's imperative to take the unconscious as a reality and refrain from altering your experiences. Try to be as faithful as possible as "The unconscious contents want first of all to be seen clearly, which can only be done by giving them shape, and to be judged only when everything they have to say is tangibly present" (C. G. Jung - V8 – §179). In this first moment, the goal is to allow the unconscious to speak it's only later that we'll criticize it with our conscious judgments.

4. The fourth phase is the key one, the one that is missing in most imagination techniques—moral confrontation with the material one has already produced. At this point Jung warns us of a mistake that is frequently made that jeopardizes the whole process. This is the mistake of entering into the inner events with a fictive ego rather than one's real ego.

Many people enter the active imagination realm as a form of escape from the conflicts of their daily lives. As a result, they try to be something that they are not and act in a way completely different from their real personalities. This can jeopardize the whole process, your ego-complex and your whole personality must be in the process.

5. Finally there is still the concluding phase—applying in daily life what one has learned in active imagination.

Again, most people fail to bring into daily lives their insights and turn them into actual experience. This is the same thing as going to therapy every week and just because you're talking about your conflicts, you pretend they're resolved. In reality, this is just a maneuver to escape from your own *soul*. Once more, active imagination is meant to be a support to life. If you're detaching from reality and feeling isolated, there's something wrong. Either you've been neglecting your commitments to real life or you're not taking the reality of the *soul* seriously. For instance, you

made a deal with an inner figure and you've been neglecting it. Without concrete action and moral confrontation, everything is useless.

Barbara Hannah says that "It took Jung many years, for he was not satisfied with learning to see the images of the unconscious, or even with dealing with them actively in his fantasies. He did not feel at ease until he took "the most important step of all": finding their place and purpose" in his own actual outer life. This, he says, the most important step in active imagination, is "what we usually neglect to do. Insight into the myth of our unconscious, must be converted into ethical obligation" (Barbara Hannah - Encounters With The Soul - p. 25).

Lastly, every time you seek knowledge from the unconscious, your responsibility increases and it becomes your duty to concretize it in real life. If you're serious about this endeavor, the one book you have to read is "Encounters With The Soul" by Barbara Hannah, Jung entrusted her to expand and write on this topic making her our main reference.

8 - The Individuation Journey and The Symbol Formation Process

Recently, I got married and my wife and I had the amazing opportunity to visit Mendoza, in Argentina. This region is famous for producing a few of the best wines in the world, currently, two vineyards are ranked in the top 10 (2024). Naturally, we had to visit them. During these tours, it's common to learn about the story of the family and how everything came to be, as well as their process of making wine. However, there's one story that stood out, the tale of Alejandro Vigil and the creation of his bodega El Enemigo.

At the time Alejandro was entertaining the idea of creating his own bodega, he was already a renowned winemaker. He was and still is the main consultant of the bodega Catena Zapata, currently number one in the world. However, despite his undeniable talent, he was unsure if he could have his own bodega and many doubts flooded his mind. One part of him wanted to dare and produce a new unique kind of wine, while the other was afraid of failure and committed to remaining small.

One of Alejandro's best friends witnessed him struggle and told him: "You should name your new bodega El Enemigo (the enemy), because what you're afraid of lives within and you must overcome this inner struggle". At that moment, Alejandro understood that he was the one standing in his own way and dared to take the first step. He confronted his own *shadow* and today, El Enemigo occupies the 9th position in the world.

This is a great story to illustrate the *individuation process* and the confrontation with the *shadow*, because one thing that few people realize is that it must take place in the real world. When people embark on the self-knowledge journey, there's an initial tendency to withdraw from the external world and spend a lot of time alone reflecting on who we truly are. In fact, many people completely isolate themselves. Although this is only natural in the beginning, this conceals a deep resistance to fully engaging with life and having real experiences, self-knowledge becomes just another coping mechanism.

While we're learning about our traumas and trying to theorize about why we are the way we are, or why our parents did such and such thing, we have an illusory sense of accomplishment and control. We feel like we're the next Freud or Jung about to change the world, but there's a problem,

it's just a theory, it's just another rationalization disconnected from reality. It's just another way to avoid facing our darkest and deepest parts, and it's just another way to avoid making tough decisions and taking a stance in life.

Carl Jung gives an amazing example in the *collected works*, there was this extremely intelligent guy who wanted to be analyzed by him. He claimed to have read all of his books and even produced an essay about his *neurosis*. Well, Jung was intrigued and accepted to see him, in fact, he told the guy that his essay was so good that he could even publish it, however, he wanted to know more about his personal life. Obviously, this stroked his ego and he went on talking about his life, apparently, he traveled a lot and lived a luxurious life despite not making a lot of money. Jung continued to ask questions and found out that this guy was manipulating a poor woman who worked as a teacher to pay for his expenses, she believed they would be together eventually, but he was just leading her on with his lies.

Jung didn't measure his words and told him that producing a thesis on his *neurosis* is useless if you don't have a real moral confrontation. The guy refused to see that he was taking advantage of this woman and said Jung knew nothing about psychology. I know this is laughable, however, it happens all of the time. People do everything they can to avoid dealing with the real problem and making an actual change, they get so enamored with their *neurosis* that they even learn all the right psychological terms to justify their lack of action. Hammer this in your head, you're not going to solve anything intellectually, theories are just meant to bring clarity, change happens with actions in the real world.

In Jung's words, "People will do anything, no matter how absurd, in order to avoid facing their own souls. They will practice Indian yoga and all its exercises, observe a strict regimen of diet, learn theosophy by heart, or mechanically repeat mystic texts from the literature of the whole world — all because they cannot get on with themselves and have not the slightest faith that anything useful could ever come out of their own souls. Thus the soul has gradually been turned into a Nazareth from which nothing good can come. Therefore let us fetch it from the four corners of the earth—the more farfetched and bizarre it is the better! I have no wish to disturb such people at their pet pursuits, but when anybody who expects to be taken seriously is deluded enough to think that I use yoga methods and yoga doctrines or that I get my patients, whenever possible, to draw mandalas for the purpose of bringing them to the “right point”—then I really must protest and tax

these people with having read my writings with the most horrible inattention” (C.G. Jung - V12 - §126).

Jung explains that the *individuation process* takes place in holding a paradox between the demands of the external world, the *persona*, and the demands of the inner world, the *soul*. This means that we have to find a balance between exerting our individuality while making concessions in our relationships and contributing to society. Also, our self-knowledge pursuits are meaningless when they're not brought to the concrete world. Just like the story of Alejandro Vigil, his confrontation with the *shadow* demanded that he dared to create something new, and not only "create" an imaginary bodega in his mind. The *individuation process* is about getting our hands dirty and paying the price to become who we truly are, it isn't static and it doesn't have a fixed and final goal, it's an ongoing process and an ideal to be pursued.

Here, I believe it's important to demystify the "myth of being cured". Many people sell this idea that we should be above any suffering and someone who overcame their traumas will live in "eternal bliss". What a bunch of crap! This conceals a childish attitude to be above the human experience and to be shielded from reality. It's just another cop-out, and if you find someone saying that they live in this eternal peace you can rest assured that they haven't even begun healing and are living in fantasy land. The *individuation process* demands that we let go of these fantasies of being a special snowflake and become more human. It's about achieving completeness rather than perfection.

Sure, by dealing with our *shadow* we will become more conscious and less reactive, and many things that used to produce suffering will dissipate. We can uncover true self-confidence, autonomy, and authenticity, and all of that translates into simply being happier and having better and healthier relationships. However, we're still human and suffering is part of life. For instance, pretending to be okay when someone important to you has died is just schizophrenic. Instead, we must learn to accept these emotions, respect our own time, and better direct them. Feelings and emotions are an important compass in our journey and dissociating from them will simply perpetuate a fragmentary existence. In fact, every time we deny a portion of ourselves we're producing these fragments, the funny thing, is that the exact things we judge as bad or inferior, are the ones that can redeem our *souls*.

Jung calls this process of "becoming complete", the *symbol formation process*. "The saving factor is the symbol, which embraces both conscious and unconscious and unites them" (C.G. Jung V6 - §466). As with everything in Jungian Psychology, this is a dialectical procedure between the conscious and unconscious, in which, we allow what once has been demonized by our conscious judgments to become part of our personalities again. "Oh but you don't know my *shadow* it's too dark!". I get it, I've been there, I've done that... The first encounter with the *shadow* tends to be horrifying, it feels like we "touched evil", however, it's daunting because it announces the death of our current personality. This is the moment we realize we must change and that everything we knew about ourselves might be wrong. This produces uncertainty and fear of the unknown, as people have the tendency to remain in a known bad situation than to open themselves to new possibilities, even though it might free them. It's an illusory sense of control.

Furthermore, we have to remember that we're still judging our *shadow* with the conscious values that created it, that's why we must strengthen our ego-complex little by little, and over time, once these contents become conscious, they're transformed. For instance, overwhelming anger can be turned into the ability to say no and place healthy boundaries. But for it to happen, we have to cultivate an open attitude toward the unconscious and start seeing these parts differently, also knowing that truth lies somewhere between the unconscious perspective and your conscious judgments. By entertaining this paradox, a new truth starts emerging, one that's capable of uniting the opposites into a higher unit, Jung calls that the *transcendent function*. In Jung's words, "The psychological "transcendent function" arises from the union of conscious and unconscious contents". [...] It is called "transcendent" because it makes the transition from one attitude to another organically possible, without loss of the unconscious" (C.G. Jung - V8 - §145).

As we've seen, a strong ego is capable of holding and entertaining opposing and complementary truths at the same time. This attitude toward the unconscious is what allows us to be guided by the *Self* and eventually achieve a sense of completeness. But again, the *Self* only inspires us to follow a certain direction, it's up to us to accommodate it in our daily lives. The *individuation journey* is about living the truth of our *souls* in our creative endeavors, in the work that we do, and in the relationships that enrich our lives. Finally, it's about living your *pistis*. In Joseph Campbell's words, "The privilege of a lifetime is being who you truly are".

9 - How To Read Carl Jung's Collected Works

In this last chapter, I'd like to leave you a few extra keys that will help you understand how Carl Jung constructed his psychology around striving to conciliate the paradoxical nature of the *psyche*. He follows a few precepts which he calls *antinomies*, which can also be understood as paradoxes.

9.1 - Antinomies

The Practice of Psychotherapy is the only place where Carl Jung reveals in a concise way how he thinks about his psychology and his psychotherapeutic method. Jung states that "The psyche is infinitely more complicated than light; hence a great number of antinomies is required to describe the nature of the psyche satisfactorily" (C. G. Jung - V16 - §1). Under this light, there's four major precepts Carl Jung follows:

1 - "Psyche depends on body and body depends on psyche".

This first statement refers to the conflict between *psyche* and matter. In psychology, this debate revolves mainly around the physicalist perspective, i.e., if the *psyche* is a mere epiphenomenon of the brain. If that's the case, the *psyche* would be considered solely a fruit of brain activity and it would be possible to influence it exclusively through physiological interventions. Taking this view to an extreme, we would be able to solve every psychological problem with surgeries and medication.

We have to remember that Carl Jung went to medical school and he was obviously aware of the influence of the body over the *psyche*, but his findings dictate that the opposite is also true, the *psyche* can also have an influence on the body. However, we can't isolate either one of them, as both work in conjunction, that's why it's a paradox. Furthermore, Carl Jung was interested in creating a psychology capable of holding these opposing and complementary truths, with the intention to create a new way of studying the *psyche* that's different from the materialistic standpoint, giving the *psyche* its own dignity.

2 - “The individual signifies nothing in comparison with the universal, and the universal signifies nothing in comparison with the individual”.

This second antinomy refers to the paradox between the individual and the collective truth. Every time we try to create a formula and something that’s generally valid, we’re hurting individuality. This creates a major problem since we need generally valid truths to live in society, to share knowledge, and to have replicability. However, it’s impossible to encompass everyone and every individual perspective. Carl Jung was aware that he needed to create a psychology that was capable of being generally valid, but at the same time, it had to respect individuality. That’s precisely why, as we’ve seen in the first chapter, he never created a theory, but a map to navigate the *psyche*.

3 - “A psychological statement is only true if its opposite can be asserted”.

This antinomy makes a direct reference to the paradoxical nature of the *psyche*, as truth is dependent on the perspective you adopt. For instance, as we’ve discussed in the *psychological types* chapter, every statement that we make about extroverts will work in the exact opposite manner for introverts, and vice-versa. When interpreting dreams, we can always interpret in a positive or negative light, the right interpretation is dependent on the individual's *conscious attitude*. Lastly, a strong ego-complex is one capable of holding opposing and complementary truths, which is the premise for the *individuation process*.

4 - “In psychotherapy there are no rules”.

In this last antinomy, Carl Jung is explaining once again his attitude toward theories. But since this statement also needs to follow his own precept, psychotherapy does have rules and at the same time, it doesn’t. We certainly need knowledge of common and recurring patterns and they’re extremely relevant to share and expand psychological knowledge, however, we always have to notice how this is being expressed in a single individual, as this will always be the most important thing. Carl Jung even states that he needs to be ready to produce a new and unique understanding to every patient he meets, knowing very well, that he’ll also find many commonalities and patterns.

9.2 - Reading Guide

With these last four keys, I believe you have everything you need to continue your journey on your own and become self-sufficient. However, one question that I have to answer all of the time is: "In what order should I read the *collected works*"? Say less, I got you! If I had to do it all over again that's exactly what I'd follow:

1 – “Man and His Symbols”.

I suggest reading only chapters 1 (Jung's chapter) and 3 (Von Franz's). Jung wrote this book after a dream that propelled him to create something for the layman to get acquainted with his ideas, making this a perfect introduction.

2 – Volume 10 – “Civilization in Transition” – Chapter 4 – “The Undiscovered Self (Present and Future)”.

In this chapter, Jung explores what self-knowledge truly means. He criticizes the statistical and scientific method, and presents us with how we can develop our own personalities and individuality.

3 - Volume 16 – “The Practice of Psychotherapy” – Part I.

This is the only book where Carl Jung gives a detailed explanation of his methods and the foundations of his thinking. Furthermore, he gives a clear explanation of the development of personality and his views on psychotherapy. Just an amazing book overall.

4 – volume 17 – “Development of Personality” – Chapter 7 also entitled “The Development of Personality”.

This is one of my favorite chapters of all time and I feel inspired every time I read it. It's important to say that “development of personality” and “*individuation process*” are synonyms, and in this book, Jung explores in-depth what this truly means and what it entails.

5 – Volume 9 – “Aion” – The First 4 Chapters – “The Ego, The Shadow, The Syzygy, and The Self”.

This book is so hard to understand that the editors asked Jung to prepare an introduction about his main concepts. This is the only time you'll see him writing about his ideas in individual chapters.

6 – Volume 18 – “Symbolic Life” – Chapter 12 – “A reply to Martin Bubber”.

This is an essential read to clearly understand Jung's position on religion and metaphysics. Spoiler alert: If you believe he was gnostic or a crazy wizard you'll be disappointed.

7 – Volume 7 – “Two Essays On Analytical Psychology”.

Now that you have a good background it's time to read the whole volume 7. Every bit of Jung's ideas are in this volume, making this one of his most important works.

8 – Volume 18 – “Symbolic Life”- Chapter 1 – “*The Travistock Lectures*”.

Here's where Jung introduces his typological method, the backbone of his psychology. It also has an introductory feel to it and it's great to read this instead of jumping right into volume 6 – The Psychological Types. Furthermore, you can see how the British fellows were trying to grill him, which also adds to an enjoyable reading, haha.

9 – Volume 9.1 – “Archetypes of the Collective Unconscious” – First 3 Chapters – “Archetypes of the Collective Unconscious”, “The Concept of the Collective Unconscious”, “Concerning the Archetypes, with Special Reference to the Anima Concept”.

Lastly, these chapters can give you a better understanding of the concept of *archetypes* and their applications.

10 – Volume 6 – “The Psychological Types”- Chapter 5 – “The Type Problem In Poetry”.

In this chapter, Jung introduces his most important idea and the goal of his entire work: The *symbol formation process*. He explores the redeeming journey our soul must endure in order to unite the opposites within, unraveling the *Self*.

11 – Bonus – “Animus and Anima” – by Emma Jung.

Emma Jung was Carl Jung’s wife, so I guess there’s no one better to teach us about the *animus* and *anima*. She writes in a very clear and concise way, a very pleasant reading overall.

12 – Pro Bonus Tip – Volume 6 – “The Psychological Types” – Chapter 11 – Definitions.

In the final part of this volume, Jung left us a kind of “dictionary”. So whenever you’re feeling lost and can’t really understand what the heck he’s talking about, you can just check the terms and concepts there.

PS: I can already see a few people rolling their eyes saying this is too much and asking me what would be absolutely essential to read. Well, Just read the first part of volume 16 and then the whole volume 7. If you want something extra go for the *Travistock Lectures*. There you go.

Intermediate Reading Guide

I could've stopped at the beginner's guide, but I know there's a few insatiable souls like me reading this right now, so I'll also share with you an intermediate reading guide.

1 – Volume 6 – “The Psychological Types”.

The volume 6 constitutes the backbone of Jungian Psychology, the *psychological types*. They're crucial to understanding everything about *psychodynamics* and his most advanced works, like alchemy. You'll gain clarity about the opposites and his paradoxical way of explaining his psychology. Pay especial attention to chapter V, where Jung explores the *symbol formation process*.

2 – "Psychotherapy" - Marie Von Franz - Chapters I & II - “Self-Realization in the Individual Therapy of C. G. Jung, and The Inferior Function”

This is the best way of complementing volume 6, as Von Franz goes in-depth on the *inferior function*.

3 – Volume 8 – “Structures and Dynamics of The Psyche”.

Skip the first part “On Psychic Energy” and begin reading the chapter “The Transcendent Function”, avoid the last chapter on “Synchronicity” for now too. This book is absolutely essential to comprehend *complexes*, *archetypes* and the notion of *psychic reality*.

4 - Volume 16 – “The Practice of Psychotherapy” – Chapter - "The Practical Use of Dream Analysis”

A great complement on dream interpretation.

5 – Volume 3 – “Psychogenesis of Mental Disease” - Chapters - "The Feeling-toned Complex and Its General Effects on the Psyche", and "On Psychological Understanding".

This one is optional, but the first chapter complements the theory of *complexes*, and the last one complements dream interpretation.

6 – Volume 11 – “Psychology and Religion”.

This book completely blew my mind. Jung explores in depth his ideas on religion, the role of the unconscious, and the *numinous* effect.

7 – "Psychotherapy" - Marie Von Franz.

If you were able to withhold yourself and read only the first 2 chapters, now it's time to tackle the whole book, a masterpiece by Von Franz.

8 – Volume 5 – “Symbols of Transformation”.

This one will absolutely blow your mind. In this one, Jung explores his most valuable idea, the *symbol formation*. In other words, he dissects the process of transformation our personality must endure in the different periods of our lives. It's a map to understand the works of the inner center - The *Self*. For a complete picture, this book must be paired with chapter 5 - "The Type Problem in Poetry" - from Volume 6, and the first chapter of volume 8 - “On Psychic Energy”.

9 – Volume 8 – “Structure and Dynamics of The Psyche” - Chapters - “On Psychic Energy”, and “Synchronicity”.

Now you may come back and read the last chapters on psychic energy and synchronicity.

10 - Volume - 9.1 - "Archetypes and the Collective Unconscious".

This last book is optional, but it's a good read if you want more background on how Jung thinks about *archetypes* and the process of individuation before jumping into his advanced works.

11 - "Alchemy - An introduction to the Symbolism and the Psychology" - Marie Von Franz

I know, I know... You want to know when we're getting to alchemy. Well, I believe that the best way to approach this theme is with this book by Von Franz, after reading it, you may go whatever direction you want.

PS: If you want to simplify things, the two most important books of the intermediate guide are Volumes 6, and even more important, the whole of Volume 8. If you want something extra, go for the book "Psychotherapy" by Von Franz, you won't regret it.

10 - About The Author

It's Rafael Krüger here and I'm extremely happy to be able to share this work with you, I hope you enjoyed it as much as I did writing it. This is one of the most audacious things I set myself to do. I've been working as a therapist since 2017 and so far I've been able to help people from over twenty countries. I can't tell you how inconceivable this was a few years ago, but that's what makes my heart beat faster, striving to surpass my own limitations and helping people break their own. I like to call that *living an audacious life*.



If you want to know more about me and my work you can visit my website:

www.rafaelkruger.com